

Hartree-Fock Theory

Pierre-François Loos

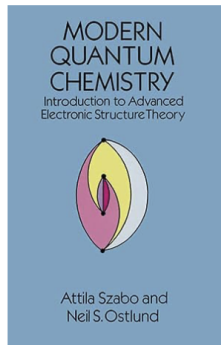
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Szabo and Ostlund's book

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Modern Quantum Chemistry: Introduction to Advanced Electronic Structure Theory (Dover Books on Chemistry)

by Attila Szabo (Author), Neil S. Ostlund (Author) | Format: Paperback

4.8 ★★★★★ (394)

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The aim of this graduate-level textbook is to present and explain, at other than a superficial level, modern *ab initio* approaches to the calculation of the electronic structure and properties of molecules. The first three chapters contain introductory material culminating in a thorough discussion of the Hartree-Fock approximation. The remaining four chapters describe a variety of more sophisticated approaches, which improve upon this approximation.

Among the highlights of the seven chapters are (1) a review of the mathematics (mostly matrix algebra) required for the rest of the book, (2) an introduction to the basic techniques, ideas, and notations of quantum chemistry, (3) a thorough discussion of the Hartree-Fock approximation, (4) a treatment of configuration interaction (CI) and approaches incorporating electron correlation, (5) a description of the independent electron pair approximation and a variety of more sophisticated approaches that incorporate coupling between pairs, (6) a consideration of the perturbative approach to the calculation of the correlation energy of many-electron systems and (7) a brief introduction to the use of the one-particle many-body Green's function in quantum chemistry.

Over 150 exercises, designed to help the reader acquire a working knowledge of the material, are embedded in the text. The book is largely self-contained and requires no prerequisite other than a solid undergraduate physical chemistry course.

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- We consider the **time-independent** Schrödinger equation
- Hartree-Fock (HF) is an **ab initio method**: it contains no empirical parameters, apart from the choice of basis set
- We neglect **relativistic effects**
- HF is a **mean-field approximation**, i.e., interactions are taken into account in an average fashion
- HF is the starting point for much of electronic structure theory

The Hamiltonian

In the Schrödinger equation

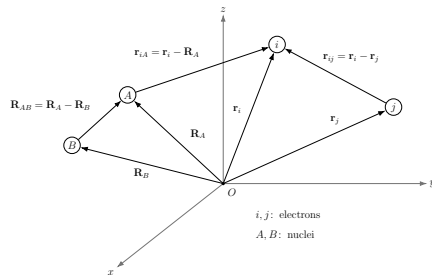
$$\hat{\mathcal{H}}\Phi(\{\mathbf{r}_i\}, \{\mathbf{R}_A\}) = \mathcal{E}\Phi(\{\mathbf{r}_i\}, \{\mathbf{R}_A\})$$

the total Hamiltonian is

$$\hat{\mathcal{H}} = \hat{\mathcal{T}}_n + \hat{\mathcal{T}}_e + \hat{\mathcal{V}}_{ne} + \hat{\mathcal{V}}_{ee} + \hat{\mathcal{V}}_{nn}$$

What are all these terms?

- $\hat{\mathcal{T}}_n$ is the kinetic energy of the nuclei
- $\hat{\mathcal{T}}_e$ is the kinetic energy of the electrons
- $\hat{\mathcal{V}}_{ne}$ is the Coulomb attraction between nuclei and electrons
- $\hat{\mathcal{V}}_{ee}$ is the Coulomb repulsion between electrons
- $\hat{\mathcal{V}}_{nn}$ is the Coulomb repulsion between nuclei



Hamiltonian terms in atomic units

In atomic units ($m = e = \hbar = 1$)

$$\hat{\mathcal{T}}_n = - \sum_{A=1}^M \frac{\nabla_A^2}{2M_A}$$

$$\hat{\mathcal{T}}_e = - \sum_{i=1}^N \frac{\nabla_i^2}{2}$$

$$\hat{\mathcal{V}}_{ne} = - \sum_{A=1}^M \sum_{i=1}^N \frac{Z_A}{r_{iA}}$$

$$\hat{\mathcal{V}}_{ee} = \sum_{i < j}^N \frac{1}{r_{ij}}$$

$$\hat{\mathcal{V}}_{nn} = \sum_{A < B}^M \frac{Z_A Z_B}{R_{AB}}$$

- ∇^2 is the Laplace operator (or Laplacian)
- M_A is the mass of nucleus A
- Z_A is the charge of nucleus A
- r_{iA} is the distance between electron i and nucleus A
- r_{ij} is the distance between electrons i and j
- R_{AB} is the distance between nuclei A and B

The Born-Oppenheimer approximation

Born-Oppenheimer approximation = decoupling nuclei and electrons

Because $M_A \gg 1$, the electrons in a molecule move in the field of fixed nuclei

$$\Phi(\{\mathbf{r}_i\}, \{\mathbf{R}_A\}) = \Phi_{\text{nucl}}(\{\mathbf{R}_A\})\Phi_{\text{elec}}(\{\mathbf{r}_i\}, \{\mathbf{R}_A\}) \quad \text{with} \quad \mathcal{E}_{\text{tot}} = \mathcal{E}_{\text{elec}} + \sum_{A < B}^M \frac{Z_A Z_B}{R_{AB}}$$

Electronic Hamiltonian

The **electronic Hamiltonian** is

$$\hat{\mathcal{H}}_{\text{elec}}\Phi_{\text{elec}} = \mathcal{E}_{\text{elec}}\Phi_{\text{elec}} \quad \text{with} \quad \boxed{\hat{\mathcal{H}}_{\text{elec}} = \hat{\mathcal{T}}_e + \hat{\mathcal{V}}_{ne} + \hat{\mathcal{V}}_{ee}}$$

Nuclear Hamiltonian

The **nuclear Hamiltonian** is

$$\hat{\mathcal{H}}_{\text{nucl}}\Phi_{\text{nucl}} = \mathcal{E}_{\text{nucl}}\Phi_{\text{nucl}} \quad \text{with} \quad \boxed{\hat{\mathcal{H}}_{\text{nucl}} = \hat{\mathcal{T}}_n + \hat{\mathcal{V}}_{nn} + \mathcal{E}_{\text{elec}}(\{\mathbf{R}_A\})}$$

It describes nuclear motions on the **potential energy surface** characterized by $\hat{\mathcal{V}}_{nn} + \mathcal{E}_{\text{elec}}(\{\mathbf{R}_A\})$

Spin of the electron

We are interested in **electrons**, which are **fermions** $\Rightarrow$ **Pauli exclusion principle** (see next slide)

Spin functions: $|\omega\rangle = |s, m_s\rangle$ $s^2 |s, m_s\rangle = s(s+1) |s, m_s\rangle$ $s_z |s, m_s\rangle = m_s |s, m_s\rangle$

$|\alpha\rangle = |\frac{1}{2}, +\frac{1}{2}\rangle = \text{spin-up electron}$ $|\beta\rangle = |\frac{1}{2}, -\frac{1}{2}\rangle = \text{spin-down electron}$

$$\begin{aligned} \int \alpha^*(\omega) \beta(\omega) d\omega &= \int \beta^*(\omega) \alpha(\omega) d\omega &= 0 & \quad \int \alpha^*(\omega) \alpha(\omega) d\omega = \int \beta^*(\omega) \beta(\omega) d\omega &= 1 \\ \langle \alpha | \beta \rangle &= \langle \beta | \alpha \rangle &= 0 & \quad \langle \alpha | \alpha \rangle = \langle \beta | \beta \rangle &= 1 \end{aligned}$$

The **composite variable** $\mathbf{x}$ combines **spin** (ω) and **spatial** ($\mathbf{r}$) coordinates: $\mathbf{x} = (\omega, \mathbf{r})$

Pauli exclusion principle

$$\hat{\mathcal{H}}_{\text{elec}} \Phi(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2, \dots, \mathbf{x}_N) = \mathcal{E}_{\text{elec}} \Phi(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2, \dots, \mathbf{x}_N)$$

$$\Phi(\mathbf{x}_1, \dots, \mathbf{x}_i, \dots, \mathbf{x}_j, \dots, \mathbf{x}_N) = -\Phi(\mathbf{x}_1, \dots, \mathbf{x}_j, \dots, \mathbf{x}_i, \dots, \mathbf{x}_N)$$

Symmetry vs Antisymmetry

Indistinguishable particles mean

$$|\Psi(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2)|^2 = |\Psi(\mathbf{x}_2, \mathbf{x}_1)|^2 \Rightarrow \Psi(\mathbf{x}_2, \mathbf{x}_1) = e^{i\theta} \Psi(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2)$$

Applying twice the **permutation operator** $\hat{\mathcal{P}}_{12}$ gives

$$\begin{aligned} \hat{\mathcal{P}}_{12} \Psi(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2) &= \Psi(\mathbf{x}_2, \mathbf{x}_1) = e^{i\theta} \Psi(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2) & \hat{\mathcal{P}}_{12}^2 \Psi(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2) &= e^{2i\theta} \Psi(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2) = \Psi(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2) \\ \Rightarrow e^{2i\theta} &= 1 \Rightarrow \theta = n\pi \Rightarrow e^{i\theta} = \pm 1 \end{aligned}$$

Bosons mean $\Psi(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2) = \Psi(\mathbf{x}_2, \mathbf{x}_1)$ and **Fermions** mean $\Psi(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2) = -\Psi(\mathbf{x}_2, \mathbf{x}_1)$

Let's put them at the same spot, i.e. $\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{x}_1 = \mathbf{x}_2$

$$\text{For Fermions, } \Psi(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{x}) = -\Psi(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{x}) \Rightarrow \Psi(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{x}) = 0$$

The wavefunction vanishes: this is the origin of the Fermi (exchange) hole

Problem:

“Given two one-electron functions $\chi_1(\mathbf{x})$ and $\chi_2(\mathbf{x})$, could you construct a two-electron (fermionic) wavefunction $\Psi(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2)$?”

Problem:

“Given two one-electron functions $\chi_1(\mathbf{x})$ and $\chi_2(\mathbf{x})$, could you construct a two-electron (fermionic) wavefunction $\Psi(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2)$?”

Solution

A possible solution is

$$\Psi(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} [\chi_1(\mathbf{x}_1)\chi_2(\mathbf{x}_2) - \chi_2(\mathbf{x}_1)\chi_1(\mathbf{x}_2)]$$

This has been popularized by Slater:

$$\Psi(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{vmatrix} \chi_1(\mathbf{x}_1) & \chi_2(\mathbf{x}_1) \\ \chi_1(\mathbf{x}_2) & \chi_2(\mathbf{x}_2) \end{vmatrix} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} [\chi_1(\mathbf{x}_1)\chi_2(\mathbf{x}_2) - \chi_2(\mathbf{x}_1)\chi_1(\mathbf{x}_2)]$$

This is called a Slater determinant!

A wavefunction of the form $\Psi(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2) = \chi_1(\mathbf{x}_1)\chi_2(\mathbf{x}_2)$ is called a Hartree product

A Slater determinant

$$\begin{aligned}\Psi_{\text{HF}}(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2, \dots, \mathbf{x}_N) &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{N!}} \begin{vmatrix} \chi_1(\mathbf{x}_1) & \chi_2(\mathbf{x}_1) & \cdots & \chi_N(\mathbf{x}_1) \\ \chi_1(\mathbf{x}_2) & \chi_2(\mathbf{x}_2) & \cdots & \chi_N(\mathbf{x}_2) \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \chi_1(\mathbf{x}_N) & \chi_2(\mathbf{x}_N) & \cdots & \chi_N(\mathbf{x}_N) \end{vmatrix} \equiv |\chi_1(\mathbf{x}_1)\chi_2(\mathbf{x}_2)\dots\chi_N(\mathbf{x}_N)\rangle \\ &= \hat{\mathcal{A}}[\chi_1(\mathbf{x}_1)\chi_2(\mathbf{x}_2)\dots\chi_N(\mathbf{x}_N)] = \hat{\mathcal{A}}\Pi(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2, \dots, \mathbf{x}_N)\end{aligned}$$

- $\hat{\mathcal{A}}$ is called the antisymmetrizer
- $\Pi(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2, \dots, \mathbf{x}_N)$ is a Hartree product
- The many-electron wavefunction $\Psi_{\text{HF}}(\mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2, \dots, \mathbf{x}_N)$ is an antisymmetrized product of one-electron functions

Spin orbitals

$$\chi_p(\mathbf{x}) = \underbrace{\sigma(\omega)}_{\text{spin}} \underbrace{\psi_p^\sigma(\mathbf{r})}_{\text{spatial}} \quad \text{with} \quad \sigma(\omega) = \begin{cases} \alpha(\omega) \\ \beta(\omega) \end{cases} \quad \text{and} \quad \psi_p^\sigma(\mathbf{r}) = \underbrace{\sum_{\mu}^K C_{\mu p}^\sigma \phi_{\mu}(\mathbf{r})}_{\text{LCAO}}$$

The spin orbitals are orthogonal

$$\begin{aligned} \langle \chi_p | \chi_q \rangle &= \int \chi_p^*(\mathbf{x}) \chi_q(\mathbf{x}) d\mathbf{x} \\ &= \delta_{pq} = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } p = q \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} = \text{Kronecker delta} \end{aligned}$$

The basis functions are, a priori, not orthogonal

$$\begin{aligned} \langle \phi_{\mu} | \phi_{\nu} \rangle &= \int \phi_{\mu}^*(\mathbf{r}) \phi_{\nu}(\mathbf{r}) d\mathbf{r} \\ &= S_{\mu\nu} = \text{Overlap matrix elements} \end{aligned}$$

Restricted vs Unrestricted Hartree-Fock

Restricted formalism

- Restricted HF (RHF) is made to describe closed-shell systems

$$\chi_p^{\text{RHF}}(\mathbf{x}) = \begin{cases} \alpha(\omega)\psi_p(\mathbf{r}) \\ \beta(\omega)\psi_p(\mathbf{r}) \end{cases} = \begin{cases} \psi_p(\mathbf{r}) \\ \bar{\psi}_p(\mathbf{r}) \end{cases}$$

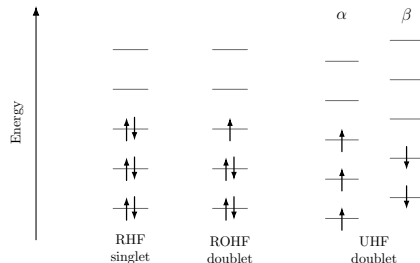
- The closed-shell RHF ansatz does **not** describe open-shell systems

Unrestricted formalism

- For open-shell systems, one can use unrestricted HF (UHF)

$$\chi_p^{\text{UHF}}(\mathbf{x}) = \begin{cases} \alpha(\omega)\psi_p^\alpha(\mathbf{r}) \\ \beta(\omega)\psi_p^\beta(\mathbf{r}) \end{cases}$$

- UHF may break spin symmetry!
- Restricted open-shell HF (ROHF) retains shared spatial orbitals (will not be discussed here!)



The restricted spatial orbitals are orthogonal

$$\langle \psi_p | \psi_q \rangle = \int \psi_p^*(\mathbf{r}) \psi_q(\mathbf{r}) d\mathbf{r} = \delta_{pq}$$

The same-spin unrestricted spatial orbitals are orthogonal

$$\langle \psi_p^\alpha | \psi_q^\alpha \rangle = \int \psi_p^{\alpha*}(\mathbf{r}) \psi_q^\alpha(\mathbf{r}) d\mathbf{r} = \delta_{pq}$$

$$\langle \psi_p^\beta | \psi_q^\beta \rangle = \int \psi_p^{\beta*}(\mathbf{r}) \psi_q^\beta(\mathbf{r}) d\mathbf{r} = \delta_{pq}$$

The opposite-spin unrestricted spatial orbitals are, a priori, not orthogonal

$$\langle \psi_p^\alpha | \psi_q^\beta \rangle = \int \psi_p^{\alpha*}(\mathbf{r}) \psi_q^\beta(\mathbf{r}) d\mathbf{r} = S_{pq}^{\alpha\beta}$$

Orbital spaces and index conventions

Orbitals

- $\{\phi_\mu | \mu = 1, \dots, K\}$ are **basis functions** or **atomic orbitals (AOs)**
- $\{\psi_p | p = 1, \dots, K\}$ are **(restricted) spatial orbitals** or **molecular orbitals (MOs)**
- $\{\chi_p | p = 1, \dots, 2K\}$ are **spin orbitals**

Indices

With K **basis functions**, one can create

- K **spatial orbitals** and $2K$ **spin orbitals** $\Rightarrow$ indices $p, q, r, s, \dots$
- N **spin orbitals** are **occupied** $\Rightarrow$ indices $i, j, k, l, \dots$
- $2K - N$ **spin orbitals** are **unoccupied/vacant** $\Rightarrow$ indices $a, b, c, d, \dots$

Closed vs Open

- When a system has **2 electrons in each orbital**, it is called a **closed-shell** system
- Otherwise, it is called an **open-shell** system
- For the ground state of a closed shell, the first $N/2$ spatial orbitals are **doubly-occupied** and the last $K - N/2$ are **vacant**

The Hartree-Fock energy

HF energy

$$E_{\text{HF}} = \langle \Psi_{\text{HF}} | \hat{\mathcal{H}}_{\text{elec}} | \Psi_{\text{HF}} \rangle \quad \text{where} \quad \hat{\mathcal{H}}_{\text{elec}} = \hat{\mathcal{T}}_{\text{e}} + \hat{\mathcal{V}}_{\text{ne}} + \hat{\mathcal{V}}_{\text{ee}}$$

One-electron Hamiltonian (or core Hamiltonian)

$$\hat{\mathcal{O}}_1 = \hat{\mathcal{T}}_{\text{e}} + \hat{\mathcal{V}}_{\text{ne}} = \sum_{i=1}^N \hat{h}(\mathbf{x}_i) \quad \text{where} \quad \hat{h}(\mathbf{x}_i) = -\frac{\nabla_i^2}{2} - \sum_{A=1}^M \frac{Z_A}{r_{iA}}$$

Two-electron Hamiltonian (electron-electron repulsion)

$$\hat{\mathcal{O}}_2 = \hat{\mathcal{V}}_{\text{ee}} = \sum_{i < j}^N \frac{1}{r_{ij}}$$

One-electron contributions to the HF energy

Electronic Hamiltonian

$$\hat{\mathcal{H}}_{\text{elec}} = \sum_{i=1}^N \hat{h}(\mathbf{x}_i) + \sum_{i<j}^N \frac{1}{r_{ij}}$$

Nuclear repulsion

$$\langle \Psi_{\text{HF}} | \hat{\mathcal{V}}_{\text{nn}} | \Psi_{\text{HF}} \rangle = V_{\text{nn}} \langle \Psi_{\text{HF}} | \Psi_{\text{HF}} \rangle = V_{\text{nn}} \quad \text{if} \quad \langle \Psi_{\text{HF}} | \Psi_{\text{HF}} \rangle = 1$$

Core Hamiltonian

$$\langle \Psi_{\text{HF}} | \hat{\mathcal{O}}_1 | \Psi_{\text{HF}} \rangle = \sum_{i=1}^N \langle \chi_i(\mathbf{x}_1) | \hat{h}(\mathbf{x}_1) | \chi_i(\mathbf{x}_1) \rangle = \sum_{i=1}^N h_{ii}$$

Two-electron contributions to the HF energy

Two-electron Hamiltonian

$$\begin{aligned}\langle \Psi_{\text{HF}} | \hat{O}_2 | \Psi_{\text{HF}} \rangle &= \sum_{i < j}^N \left[\langle \chi_i(\mathbf{x}_1) \chi_j(\mathbf{x}_2) | r_{12}^{-1} | \chi_i(\mathbf{x}_1) \chi_j(\mathbf{x}_2) \rangle - \langle \chi_i(\mathbf{x}_1) \chi_j(\mathbf{x}_2) | r_{12}^{-1} | \chi_j(\mathbf{x}_1) \chi_i(\mathbf{x}_2) \rangle \right] \\ &= \sum_{i < j}^N \left(\underbrace{\mathcal{J}_{ij}}_{\text{Coulomb}} - \underbrace{\mathcal{K}_{ij}}_{\text{Exchange}} \right) = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i=1}^N \sum_{j=1}^N (\mathcal{J}_{ij} - \mathcal{K}_{ij}) \quad \text{because} \quad \boxed{\mathcal{J}_{ii} = \mathcal{K}_{ii}}\end{aligned}$$

HF energy

$$\boxed{E_{\text{HF}} = \sum_{i=1}^N h_{ii} + \sum_{i < j}^N (\mathcal{J}_{ij} - \mathcal{K}_{ij})}$$

Coulomb operator

Coulomb operator

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{\mathcal{J}}_j(\mathbf{x}_1) |\chi_i(\mathbf{x}_1)\rangle &= \langle \chi_j(\mathbf{x}_2) | r_{12}^{-1} | \chi_j(\mathbf{x}_2) \rangle |\chi_i(\mathbf{x}_1)\rangle \\ &= \left[\int \chi_j^*(\mathbf{x}_2) r_{12}^{-1} \chi_j(\mathbf{x}_2) d\mathbf{x}_2 \right] |\chi_i(\mathbf{x}_1)\rangle\end{aligned}$$

Coulomb matrix elements

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{J}_{ij} &= \langle \chi_i(\mathbf{x}_1) | \hat{\mathcal{J}}_j(\mathbf{x}_1) | \chi_i(\mathbf{x}_1) \rangle \\ &= \langle \chi_i(\mathbf{x}_1) \chi_j(\mathbf{x}_2) | r_{12}^{-1} | \chi_i(\mathbf{x}_1) \chi_j(\mathbf{x}_2) \rangle \\ &= \iint \chi_i^*(\mathbf{x}_1) \chi_j^*(\mathbf{x}_2) r_{12}^{-1} \chi_i(\mathbf{x}_1) \chi_j(\mathbf{x}_2) d\mathbf{x}_1 d\mathbf{x}_2\end{aligned}$$

Exchange operator

(non-local) Exchange operator

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{\mathcal{K}}_j(\mathbf{x}_1) |\chi_i(\mathbf{x}_1)\rangle &= \langle \chi_j(\mathbf{x}_2) | r_{12}^{-1} | \chi_i(\mathbf{x}_2) \rangle |\chi_j(\mathbf{x}_1)\rangle \\ &= \left[\int \chi_j^*(\mathbf{x}_2) r_{12}^{-1} \chi_i(\mathbf{x}_2) d\mathbf{x}_2 \right] |\chi_j(\mathbf{x}_1)\rangle\end{aligned}$$

Exchange matrix elements

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{K}_{ij} &= \langle \chi_i(\mathbf{x}_1) | \hat{\mathcal{K}}_j(\mathbf{x}_1) | \chi_i(\mathbf{x}_1) \rangle \\ &= \langle \chi_i(\mathbf{x}_1) \chi_j(\mathbf{x}_2) | r_{12}^{-1} | \chi_j(\mathbf{x}_1) \chi_i(\mathbf{x}_2) \rangle \\ &= \iint \chi_i^*(\mathbf{x}_1) \chi_j^*(\mathbf{x}_2) r_{12}^{-1} \chi_j(\mathbf{x}_1) \chi_i(\mathbf{x}_2) d\mathbf{x}_1 d\mathbf{x}_2\end{aligned}$$

Spin orbitals

$$\langle i|\hat{h}|j\rangle = h_{ij} = \langle \chi_i|\hat{h}|\chi_j\rangle = \int \chi_i^*(\mathbf{x}_1)\hat{h}(\mathbf{r}_1)\chi_j(\mathbf{x}_1) d\mathbf{x}_1$$

$$\langle ij|kl\rangle = \langle \chi_i\chi_j|\chi_k\chi_l\rangle = \iint \chi_i^*(\mathbf{x}_1)\chi_j^*(\mathbf{x}_2)\frac{1}{r_{12}}\chi_k(\mathbf{x}_1)\chi_l(\mathbf{x}_2) d\mathbf{x}_1 d\mathbf{x}_2$$

$$\langle ij||kl\rangle = \langle ij|kl\rangle - \langle ij|lk\rangle = \iint \chi_i^*(\mathbf{x}_1)\chi_j^*(\mathbf{x}_2)\frac{1}{r_{12}}\left(1 - \hat{\mathcal{P}}_{12}\right)\chi_k(\mathbf{x}_1)\chi_l(\mathbf{x}_2) d\mathbf{x}_1 d\mathbf{x}_2$$

Spatial orbitals

$$\langle i|\hat{h}|j\rangle = h_{ij} = (\psi_i|\hat{h}|\psi_j) = \int \psi_i^*(\mathbf{r}_1)\hat{h}(\mathbf{r}_1)\psi_j(\mathbf{r}_1) d\mathbf{r}_1$$

$$(ij|kl) = (\psi_i\psi_j|\psi_k\psi_l) = \iint \psi_i^*(\mathbf{r}_1)\psi_j(\mathbf{r}_1)\frac{1}{r_{12}}\psi_k^*(\mathbf{r}_2)\psi_l(\mathbf{r}_2) d\mathbf{r}_1 d\mathbf{r}_2$$

Permutation symmetry in physicists' notation

$$\langle ij|kl \rangle = \langle \chi_i \chi_j | \chi_k \chi_l \rangle = \iint \chi_i^*(\mathbf{x}_1) \chi_j^*(\mathbf{x}_2) \frac{1}{r_{12}} \chi_k(\mathbf{x}_1) \chi_l(\mathbf{x}_2) d\mathbf{x}_1 d\mathbf{x}_2$$

Complex-valued integrals: $\langle ij|kl \rangle = \langle ji|lk \rangle = \langle kl|ij \rangle^* = \langle lk|ji \rangle^*$

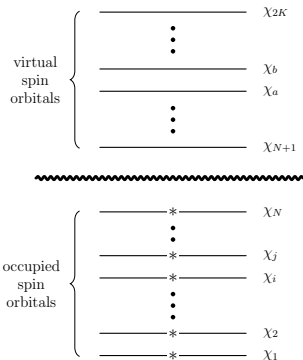
Permutation symmetry in chemists' notation

$$(ij|kl) = (\chi_i \chi_j | \chi_k \chi_l) = \iint \chi_i^*(\mathbf{x}_1) \chi_j(\mathbf{x}_1) \frac{1}{r_{12}} \chi_k^*(\mathbf{x}_2) \chi_l(\mathbf{x}_2) d\mathbf{x}_1 d\mathbf{x}_2$$

Real-valued integrals: $(ij|kl) = (ji|kl) = (ij|lk) = (ji|lk) = (kl|ij) = (lk|ij) = (kl|ji) = (lk|ji)$

Reference ground-state determinant

The electrons are in the N lowest spin orbitals (Aufbau principle): $|\Psi_0\rangle = |\chi_1 \dots \chi_i \chi_j \dots \chi_N\rangle$



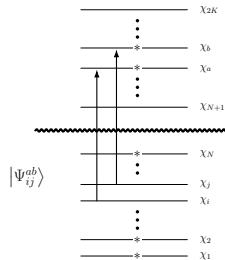
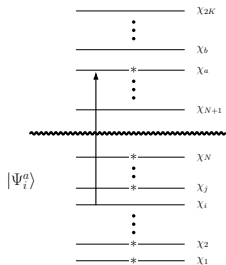
Excited determinants

Singly-excited determinants

Electron in i promoted in a : $|\Psi_i^a\rangle = |\chi_1 \dots \chi_a \chi_j \dots \chi_N\rangle = \hat{a}_a^\dagger \hat{a}_i |\Psi_0\rangle$

Doubly-excited determinants

Electrons in i and j promoted in a and b : $|\Psi_{ij}^{ab}\rangle = |\chi_1 \dots \chi_a \chi_b \dots \chi_N\rangle = \hat{a}_a^\dagger \hat{a}_b^\dagger \hat{a}_j \hat{a}_i |\Psi_0\rangle$



Slater-Condon rules: One-electron operators

$$\hat{O}_1 = \sum_i^N \hat{h}(\mathbf{r}_i)$$

Case 1: determinants differ by zero spin orbitals

$$|K\rangle = |\cdots ij \cdots\rangle \Rightarrow \langle K | \hat{O}_1 | K \rangle = \sum_i^N \langle i | \hat{h} | i \rangle \quad \text{Example: } \langle \Psi_0 | \hat{O}_1 | \Psi_0 \rangle = \sum_i^N h_{ii}$$

Case 2: determinants differ by one spin orbital

$$|K\rangle = |\cdots ij \cdots\rangle \text{ and } |L\rangle = |\cdots kj \cdots\rangle \Rightarrow \langle K | \hat{O}_1 | L \rangle = \langle i | \hat{h} | k \rangle \quad \text{Example: } \langle \Psi_0 | \hat{O}_1 | \Psi_i^a \rangle = h_{ia}$$

Case 3: determinants differ by two spin orbitals

$$|K\rangle = |\cdots ij \cdots\rangle \text{ and } |L\rangle = |\cdots kl \cdots\rangle \Rightarrow \langle K | \hat{O}_1 | L \rangle = 0 \quad \text{Example: } \langle \Psi_0 | \hat{O}_1 | \Psi_{ij}^{ab} \rangle = 0$$

Slater-Condon rules: Two-electron operators

$$\hat{O}_2 = \sum_{i < j}^N r_{ij}^{-1}$$

Case 1: determinants differ by zero spin orbitals

$$|K\rangle = |\cdots ij \cdots\rangle \Rightarrow \langle K | \hat{O}_2 | K \rangle = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{ij}^N \langle ij || ij \rangle \quad \text{Example: } \langle \Psi_0 | \hat{O}_2 | \Psi_0 \rangle = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{ij}^N \langle ij || ij \rangle$$

Case 2: determinants differ by one spin orbital

$$|K\rangle = |\cdots ij \cdots\rangle \text{ and } |L\rangle = |\cdots kj \cdots\rangle \Rightarrow \langle K | \hat{O}_2 | L \rangle = \sum_j^N \langle ij || kj \rangle \quad \text{Example: } \langle \Psi_0 | \hat{O}_2 | \Psi_i^a \rangle = \sum_k^N \langle ik || ak \rangle$$

Case 3: determinants differ by two spin orbitals

$$|K\rangle = |\cdots ij \cdots\rangle \text{ and } |L\rangle = |\cdots kl \cdots\rangle \Rightarrow \langle K | \hat{O}_2 | L \rangle = \langle ij || kl \rangle \quad \text{Example: } \langle \Psi_0 | \hat{O}_2 | \Psi_{ij}^{ab} \rangle = \langle ij || ab \rangle$$

Excited determinant vs excited HF solution

An excited determinant is

- ✓ An orbital substitution within a **fixed** set of reference orbitals
- ✓ A valid many-electron basis function
- ✓ A building block for CI and CC expansions

An excited determinant is generally not

- ✗ A separately optimized HF state
- ✗ A stationary point of the HF energy
- ✗ An eigenfunction of $\hat{S}^2$

Brillouin's theorem

For a stationary HF reference, the Hamiltonian does not couple the reference determinant to a singly-excited determinant:

$$\langle \Psi_0 | \hat{\mathcal{H}}_{\text{elec}} | \Psi_i^a \rangle = h_{ia} + \sum_k^N \langle ik || ak \rangle = f_{ia} = 0$$

⇒ Orbital excitation and state optimization are different procedures

Spin of many-electron wavefunctions

Spin operators

In the nonrelativistic, spin-free framework, $\hat{\mathcal{H}}$ commutes with the **total spin operators**

$$\left[\hat{\mathcal{H}}, \hat{\mathcal{S}}^2 \right] = 0 \quad \text{and} \quad \left[\hat{\mathcal{H}}, \hat{\mathcal{S}}_z \right] = 0$$

The eigenfunctions of $\hat{\mathcal{H}}$ may therefore be chosen as simultaneous eigenfunctions of $\hat{\mathcal{S}}^2$ and $\hat{\mathcal{S}}_z$:

$$\hat{\mathcal{S}}^2 |S, M_S\rangle = S(S+1) |S, M_S\rangle$$

$$\hat{\mathcal{S}}_z |S, M_S\rangle = M_S |S, M_S\rangle$$

Spin quantum numbers

- S determines the **spin multiplicity** $2S + 1$:
 - $S = 0$ for singlets
 - $S = 1/2$ for doublets
 - $S = 1$ for triplets
 - ...
- $M_S = -S, -S + 1, \dots, S - 1, S$ is its **spin projection**

Are HF wavefunctions spin eigenfunctions?

For a **collinear*** determinant $|\Psi\rangle$ containing N^α spin-up and N^β spin-down orbitals, one has

$$\hat{S}_z |\Psi\rangle = M_S |\Psi\rangle \quad \text{with} \quad M_S = \frac{N^\alpha - N^\beta}{2}$$

Closed-shell RHF

Every spatial orbital is doubly occupied:

$$\hat{S}^2 |\Psi_{\text{RHF}}\rangle = 0$$

The determinant is a **pure singlet**

Open-shell UHF

The spin-up and spin-down spatial orbitals are different:

$$\hat{S}^2 |\Psi_{\text{UHF}}\rangle \neq S(S+1) |\Psi_{\text{UHF}}\rangle$$

in general

⇒ Every RHF or UHF determinant has a well-defined M_S , but only specific determinants have a well-defined S

*In a collinear determinant, the occupied spin orbitals all have spin aligned along one common quantization axis

Spin contamination in UHF

For $N^\alpha \geq N^\beta$, a UHF determinant satisfies

$$\left\langle \hat{S}^2 \right\rangle_{\text{UHF}} = M_S(M_S + 1) + N^\beta - \sum_{i=1}^{N^\alpha} \sum_{j=1}^{N^\beta} \left| S_{ij}^{\alpha\beta} \right|^2 \quad \text{with} \quad \underbrace{S_{ij}^{\alpha\beta}}_{\text{overlap}} = \left\langle \psi_i^\alpha \middle| \psi_j^\beta \right\rangle$$

Spin contamination

For a target high-spin state with $S = M_S$,

$$\Delta S^2 = \left\langle \hat{S}^2 \right\rangle_{\text{UHF}} - \left\langle \hat{S}^2 \right\rangle_{\text{exact}} \geq 0$$

- A singlet may be contaminated by triplets, quintets, ...
- A doublet may be contaminated by quartets, sextets, ...
- A triplet may be contaminated by quintets, septets, ...
- Restoring spin symmetry generally requires **spin projection** or **a linear combination of determinants**

Are excited determinants based on restricted orbitals spin eigenfunctions?

Starting from a closed-shell singlet reference $|\Psi_0\rangle$

$$|D_\alpha\rangle = \hat{a}_{a\alpha}^\dagger \hat{a}_{i\alpha} |\Psi_0\rangle$$

$$|D_\beta\rangle = \hat{a}_{a\beta}^\dagger \hat{a}_{i\beta} |\Psi_0\rangle$$

$$\hat{S}_z |D_\sigma\rangle = 0$$

$$\langle D_\sigma | \hat{S}^2 | D_\sigma \rangle = 1$$

$|D_\alpha\rangle$: excite the spin-up electron



$|D_\beta\rangle$: excite the spin-down electron



Same M_S , indefinite total spin

Each determinant has $M_S = 0$, but contains equal singlet and triplet character. Being an eigenfunction of $\hat{S}_z$ does not imply being an eigenfunction of $\hat{S}^2$

⇒ Open-shell determinants might not be pure spin functions!

How to get pure singlets and triplets?

In the two-determinant basis $\{ |D_\alpha\rangle, |D_\beta\rangle \}$,

$$\left[\hat{\mathcal{S}}^2 \right]_{\{D_\alpha, D_\beta\}} = \begin{pmatrix} +1 & -1 \\ -1 & +1 \end{pmatrix}$$

Pure singlet

$$|{}^1\Psi_i^a\rangle = \frac{|D_\alpha\rangle + |D_\beta\rangle}{\sqrt{2}}$$

$$\hat{\mathcal{S}}^2 |{}^1\Psi_i^a\rangle = 0 \quad \Rightarrow \quad S = 0$$

Pure triplet with $M_S = 0$

$$|{}^{3,0}\Psi_i^a\rangle = \frac{|D_\alpha\rangle - |D_\beta\rangle}{\sqrt{2}}$$

$$\hat{\mathcal{S}}^2 |{}^{3,0}\Psi_i^a\rangle = 2 |{}^{3,0}\Psi_i^a\rangle \quad \Rightarrow \quad S = 1$$

$\Rightarrow$ spin adaptation = diagonalization of $\hat{\mathcal{S}}^2$ in a determinant space

Open-shell singlet

For the two open-shell spatial orbitals i and a , the singlet is

$$|{}^1\Psi_i^a\rangle = \frac{1}{2} \underbrace{[|\phi_i(1)\phi_a(2)\rangle + |\phi_a(1)\phi_i(2)\rangle]}_{\text{spatially symmetric}} \underbrace{[\alpha(1)\beta(2) - \beta(1)\alpha(2)]}_{\text{spin antisymmetric}}$$

symmetric spatial part $\times$ antisymmetric spin part

Triplet with $M_S = 0$

The $M_S = 0$ triplet is

$$|{}^{3,0}\Psi_i^a\rangle = \frac{1}{2} \underbrace{[|\phi_i(1)\phi_a(2)\rangle - |\phi_a(1)\phi_i(2)\rangle]}_{\text{spatially antisymmetric}} \underbrace{[\alpha(1)\beta(2) + \beta(1)\alpha(2)]}_{\text{spin symmetric}}$$

antisymmetric spatial part $\times$ symmetric spin part

$\Rightarrow$ The total electronic wavefunction is antisymmetric in both cases

The three components of the triplet

Components of the $S = 1$ multiplet

$$|^{3,+1}\Psi_i^a\rangle = |\dots i^\alpha a^\alpha \dots\rangle$$

$$|^{3,0}\Psi_i^a\rangle = \frac{|D_\alpha\rangle - |D_\beta\rangle}{\sqrt{2}}$$

$$|^{3,-1}\Psi_i^a\rangle = |\dots i^\beta a^\beta \dots\rangle$$

Every component satisfies

$$\hat{S}^2 |1, M_S\rangle = 2 |1, M_S\rangle$$

$$\hat{S}_z |1, M_S\rangle = M_S |1, M_S\rangle$$

They are connected by

$$\underbrace{\hat{S}_\pm}_{\text{ladder operator}} |S, M_S\rangle = \sqrt{S(S+1) - M_S(M_S \pm 1)} |S, M_S \pm 1\rangle$$

$$M_S = \pm 1$$

Each component is a single spin-pure determinant

$$M_S = 0$$

The pure triplet requires two determinants

Normalization of a two-electron determinant

Problem: Normalization of the HF wavefunction

“Show that the HF wavefunction built with two (normalized) orthogonal spin orbitals χ_1 and χ_2 is normalized”

Normalization of a two-electron determinant

Problem: Normalization of the HF wavefunction

“Show that the HF wavefunction built with two (normalized) orthogonal spin orbitals χ_1 and χ_2 is normalized”

Solution

$$\begin{aligned}\Psi_{\text{HF}} &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{vmatrix} \chi_1(1) & \chi_2(1) \\ \chi_1(2) & \chi_2(2) \end{vmatrix} = \frac{\chi_1(1)\chi_2(2) - \chi_1(2)\chi_2(1)}{\sqrt{2}} \\ \langle \Psi_{\text{HF}} | \Psi_{\text{HF}} \rangle &= \frac{1}{2} \langle \chi_1(1)\chi_2(2) - \chi_2(1)\chi_1(2) | \chi_1(1)\chi_2(2) - \chi_2(1)\chi_1(2) \rangle \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \left[\langle \chi_1(1)\chi_2(2) | \chi_1(1)\chi_2(2) \rangle - \langle \chi_1(1)\chi_2(2) | \chi_2(1)\chi_1(2) \rangle \right. \\ &\quad \left. - \langle \chi_2(1)\chi_1(2) | \chi_1(1)\chi_2(2) \rangle + \langle \chi_2(1)\chi_1(2) | \chi_2(1)\chi_1(2) \rangle \right] \\ &= \frac{1}{2} [1 - 0 - 0 + 1] = 1\end{aligned}$$

Remember that $\langle \chi_1(1)\chi_2(2) | \chi_1(1)\chi_2(2) \rangle = \langle \chi_1(1) | \chi_1(1) \rangle \langle \chi_2(2) | \chi_2(2) \rangle$

One-electron energy of a two-electron determinant

Problem: Core Hamiltonian

“Show that $\langle \Psi_{HF} | \hat{O}_1 | \Psi_{HF} \rangle = \sum_{i=1}^N h_{ii}$ for the same system”

One-electron energy of a two-electron determinant

Problem: Core Hamiltonian

“Show that $\langle \Psi_{HF} | \hat{O}_1 | \Psi_{HF} \rangle = \sum_{i=1}^N h_{ii}$ for the same system”

Solution

$$\hat{O}_1 = \hat{h}(1) + \hat{h}(2)$$

$$\begin{aligned} & \langle \Psi_{HF} | \hat{h}(1) + \hat{h}(2) | \Psi_{HF} \rangle \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \langle \chi_1(1)\chi_2(2) - \chi_1(2)\chi_2(1) | \hat{h}(1) + \hat{h}(2) | \chi_1(1)\chi_2(2) - \chi_1(2)\chi_2(1) \rangle \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \left[\langle \chi_1(1)\chi_2(2) | \hat{h}(1) + \hat{h}(2) | \chi_1(1)\chi_2(2) \rangle - \langle \chi_1(1)\chi_2(2) | \hat{h}(1) + \hat{h}(2) | \chi_2(1)\chi_1(2) \rangle \right. \\ &\quad \left. - \langle \chi_2(1)\chi_1(2) | \hat{h}(1) + \hat{h}(2) | \chi_1(1)\chi_2(2) \rangle + \langle \chi_2(1)\chi_1(2) | \hat{h}(1) + \hat{h}(2) | \chi_2(1)\chi_1(2) \rangle \right] \\ &= \frac{1}{2} [h_{11} + h_{22} - 0 - 0 + h_{22} + h_{11}] = h_{11} + h_{22} \end{aligned}$$

Electron interaction in a two-electron determinant

Problem: Two-electron Hamiltonian

“Show that $\langle \Psi_{HF} | \hat{O}_2 | \Psi_{HF} \rangle = \sum_{i < j}^N (\mathcal{J}_{ij} - \mathcal{K}_{ij})$ for the same system and write down the HF energy”

Electron interaction in a two-electron determinant

Problem: Two-electron Hamiltonian

“Show that $\langle \Psi_{\text{HF}} | \hat{O}_2 | \Psi_{\text{HF}} \rangle = \sum_{i < j}^N (\mathcal{J}_{ij} - \mathcal{K}_{ij})$ for the same system and write down the HF energy”

Solution

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{O}_2 &= r_{12}^{-1} \\ \langle \Psi_{\text{HF}} | r_{12}^{-1} | \Psi_{\text{HF}} \rangle &= \frac{1}{2} \langle \chi_1 \chi_2 - \chi_2 \chi_1 | r_{12}^{-1} | \chi_1 \chi_2 - \chi_2 \chi_1 \rangle \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \left[\langle \chi_1 \chi_2 | r_{12}^{-1} | \chi_1 \chi_2 \rangle - \langle \chi_1 \chi_2 | r_{12}^{-1} | \chi_2 \chi_1 \rangle \right. \\ &\quad \left. - \langle \chi_2 \chi_1 | r_{12}^{-1} | \chi_1 \chi_2 \rangle + \langle \chi_2 \chi_1 | r_{12}^{-1} | \chi_2 \chi_1 \rangle \right] \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \left[\mathcal{J}_{12} - \mathcal{K}_{12} - \mathcal{K}_{12} + \mathcal{J}_{12} \right] = \mathcal{J}_{12} - \mathcal{K}_{12}\end{aligned}$$

Remember that $\langle \chi_2 \chi_1 | r_{12}^{-1} | \chi_2 \chi_1 \rangle = \langle \chi_1 \chi_2 | r_{12}^{-1} | \chi_1 \chi_2 \rangle$

$$E_{\text{HF}} = h_{11} + h_{22} + \mathcal{J}_{12} - \mathcal{K}_{12}$$

HF energy of a three-electron system

Three-electron system

“Find the HF energy of a three-electron system composed of the spin orbitals χ_1 , χ_2 and χ_3 ”

HF energy of a three-electron system

Three-electron system

“Find the HF energy of a three-electron system composed of the spin orbitals χ_1 , χ_2 and χ_3 ”

Solution

$$\hat{O}_1 = \hat{h}(\mathbf{x}_1) + \hat{h}(\mathbf{x}_2) + \hat{h}(\mathbf{x}_3)$$

$$\hat{O}_2 = r_{12}^{-1} + r_{13}^{-1} + r_{23}^{-1}$$

$$\vdots$$

$$E_{\text{HF}} = h_{11} + h_{22} + h_{33} + \mathcal{J}_{12} + \mathcal{J}_{13} + \mathcal{J}_{23} - \mathcal{K}_{12} - \mathcal{K}_{13} - \mathcal{K}_{23}$$

Closed-shell H₂ in spatial orbitals

Two-electron example: H₂ in minimal basis

In the spin orbital basis, we have

$$E_{\text{HF}} = \langle \chi_1 | \hat{h} | \chi_1 \rangle + \langle \chi_2 | \hat{h} | \chi_2 \rangle + \langle \chi_1 \chi_2 | \chi_1 \chi_2 \rangle - \langle \chi_1 \chi_2 | \chi_2 \chi_1 \rangle$$

Spin to spatial transformation:

$$\chi_1(\mathbf{x}) \equiv \psi_1(\mathbf{x}) = \psi_1(\mathbf{r})\alpha(\omega)$$

$$\chi_2(\mathbf{x}) \equiv \bar{\psi}_1(\mathbf{x}) = \psi_1(\mathbf{r})\beta(\omega)$$

$$E_{\text{HF}} = (\psi_1 | \hat{h} | \psi_1) + (\bar{\psi}_1 | \hat{h} | \bar{\psi}_1) + (\psi_1 \psi_1 | \bar{\psi}_1 \bar{\psi}_1) - (\psi_1 \bar{\psi}_1 | \bar{\psi}_1 \psi_1)$$

Therefore, in the spatial orbital basis, we have

$$E_{\text{HF}} = 2(\psi_1 | \hat{h} | \psi_1) + (\psi_1 \psi_1 | \psi_1 \psi_1) = 2(1 | \hat{h} | 1) + (11 | 11)$$

$$|\Psi_0\rangle = \begin{array}{cc} \chi_3 & \text{---} & \text{---} & \chi_4 \\ \chi_1 & \text{---} * \text{---} & \text{---} * \text{---} & \chi_2 \end{array}$$

$$\equiv \begin{array}{cc} \chi_3 & \text{---} & \text{---} & \chi_4 \\ \chi_1 & \text{---} \uparrow & \text{---} \downarrow & \chi_2 \end{array}$$

$$\equiv \begin{array}{cc} & \text{---} & \psi_2 \\ & \text{---} \uparrow \downarrow & \psi_1 \end{array}$$

One-electron terms

$$\begin{aligned}(\chi_1|\hat{h}|\chi_1) &= \int \chi_1^*(\mathbf{x}) \hat{h}(\mathbf{r}) \chi_1(\mathbf{x}) d\mathbf{x} \\&= \iint \alpha^*(\omega) \psi_1^*(\mathbf{r}) \hat{h}(\mathbf{r}) \alpha(\omega) \psi_1(\mathbf{r}) d\omega d\mathbf{r} \\&= \underbrace{\left[\int \alpha^*(\omega) \alpha(\omega) d\omega \right]}_{=1} \underbrace{\left[\int \psi_1^*(\mathbf{r}) \hat{h}(\mathbf{r}) \psi_1(\mathbf{r}) d\mathbf{r} \right]}_{(\psi_1|\hat{h}|\psi_1)}\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}(\chi_2|\hat{h}|\chi_2) &= \int \chi_2^*(\mathbf{x}) \hat{h}(\mathbf{r}) \chi_2(\mathbf{x}) d\mathbf{x} \\&= \iint \beta^*(\omega) \psi_1^*(\mathbf{r}) \hat{h}(\mathbf{r}) \beta(\omega) \psi_1(\mathbf{r}) d\omega d\mathbf{r} \\&= \underbrace{\left[\int \beta^*(\omega) \beta(\omega) d\omega \right]}_{=1} \underbrace{\left[\int \psi_1^*(\mathbf{r}) \hat{h}(\mathbf{r}) \psi_1(\mathbf{r}) d\mathbf{r} \right]}_{(\psi_1|\hat{h}|\psi_1)}\end{aligned}$$

Two-electron terms

$$\begin{aligned}
 (\chi_1 \chi_1 | \chi_2 \chi_2) &= \iint \chi_1^*(\mathbf{x}_1) \chi_1(\mathbf{x}_1) r_{12}^{-1} \chi_2^*(\mathbf{x}_2) \chi_2(\mathbf{x}_2) d\mathbf{x}_1 d\mathbf{x}_2 \\
 &= \iint \iint \alpha^*(\omega_1) \psi_1^*(\mathbf{r}_1) \alpha(\omega_1) \psi_1(\mathbf{r}_1) r_{12}^{-1} \beta^*(\omega_2) \psi_1^*(\mathbf{r}_2) \beta(\omega_2) \psi_1(\mathbf{r}_2) d\omega_1 d\mathbf{r}_1 d\omega_2 d\mathbf{r}_2 \\
 &= \underbrace{\left[\int \alpha^*(\omega_1) \alpha(\omega_1) d\omega_1 \right]}_{=1} \underbrace{\left[\int \beta^*(\omega_2) \beta(\omega_2) d\omega_2 \right]}_{=1} \underbrace{\left[\iint \psi_1^*(\mathbf{r}_1) \psi_1(\mathbf{r}_1) r_{12}^{-1} \psi_1^*(\mathbf{r}_2) \psi_1(\mathbf{r}_2) d\mathbf{r}_1 d\mathbf{r}_2 \right]}_{(\psi_1 \psi_1 | \psi_1 \psi_1)}
 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 (\chi_1 \chi_2 | \chi_2 \chi_1) &= \iint \chi_1^*(\mathbf{x}_1) \chi_2(\mathbf{x}_1) r_{12}^{-1} \chi_2^*(\mathbf{x}_2) \chi_1(\mathbf{x}_2) d\mathbf{x}_1 d\mathbf{x}_2 \\
 &= \iint \iint \alpha^*(\omega_1) \psi_1^*(\mathbf{r}_1) \beta(\omega_1) \psi_1(\mathbf{r}_1) r_{12}^{-1} \beta^*(\omega_2) \psi_1^*(\mathbf{r}_2) \alpha(\omega_2) \psi_1(\mathbf{r}_2) d\omega_1 d\mathbf{r}_1 d\omega_2 d\mathbf{r}_2 \\
 &= \underbrace{\left[\int \alpha^*(\omega_1) \beta(\omega_1) d\omega_1 \right]}_{=0} \underbrace{\left[\int \beta^*(\omega_2) \alpha(\omega_2) d\omega_2 \right]}_{=0} \underbrace{\left[\iint \psi_1^*(\mathbf{r}_1) \psi_1(\mathbf{r}_1) r_{12}^{-1} \psi_1^*(\mathbf{r}_2) \psi_1(\mathbf{r}_2) d\mathbf{r}_1 d\mathbf{r}_2 \right]}_{(\psi_1 \psi_1 | \psi_1 \psi_1)}
 \end{aligned}$$

Closed-shell Hartree-Fock energy in spatial orbitals

General expression

$$E_{\text{HF}} = \sum_i^N \langle i | \hat{h} | i \rangle + \frac{1}{2} \sum_i^N \sum_j^N [\langle ij | ij \rangle - \langle ij | ji \rangle] = 2 \sum_i^{N/2} \langle i | \hat{h} | i \rangle + \sum_i^{N/2} \sum_j^{N/2} [2 \langle ii | jj \rangle - \langle ij | ji \rangle]$$

One- and two-electron terms

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_i^N \langle i | \hat{h} | i \rangle &= \sum_i^{N/2} \langle i | \hat{h} | i \rangle + \sum_i^{N/2} \langle \bar{i} | \hat{h} | \bar{i} \rangle = 2 \sum_i^{N/2} \langle i | \hat{h} | i \rangle \\ \frac{1}{2} \sum_i^N \sum_j^N [\langle ij | ij \rangle - \langle ij | ji \rangle] &= \frac{1}{2} \left\{ \sum_i^{N/2} \sum_j^{N/2} (\langle ij | ij \rangle - \langle ij | ji \rangle) + \sum_i^{N/2} \sum_j^{N/2} (\langle \bar{i} \bar{j} | \bar{i} \bar{j} \rangle - \langle \bar{i} \bar{j} | \bar{j} \bar{i} \rangle) \right. \\ &\quad \left. + \sum_i^{N/2} \sum_j^{N/2} (\langle i \bar{j} | i \bar{j} \rangle - \langle i \bar{j} | \bar{j} i \rangle) + \sum_i^{N/2} \sum_j^{N/2} (\langle \bar{i} j | \bar{i} j \rangle - \langle \bar{i} j | j \bar{i} \rangle) \right\} \\ &= \sum_i^{N/2} \sum_j^{N/2} [2 \langle ii | jj \rangle - \langle ij | ji \rangle] \end{aligned}$$

Problem: HF energy of the Li atom

“Find the HF energy of the Li atom in terms of spatial orbitals”

Problem: HF energy of the Li atom

“Find the HF energy of the Li atom in terms of spatial orbitals”

Solution

$$\chi_1 = \alpha\psi_1 \quad \chi_2 = \beta\psi_1 \quad \chi_3 = \alpha\psi_2$$

$$E_{\text{HF}} = 2h_{11} + h_{22} + J_{11} + 2J_{12} - K_{12}$$

Hartree-Fock energy of atoms

Problem: HF energy of the Li atom

“Find the HF energy of the Li atom in terms of spatial orbitals”

Solution

$$\chi_1 = \alpha\psi_1 \quad \chi_2 = \beta\psi_1 \quad \chi_3 = \alpha\psi_2$$

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Problem: HF energy of the B atom

“Find the HF energy of the B atom in terms of spatial orbitals”

Hartree-Fock energy of atoms

Problem: HF energy of the Li atom

“Find the HF energy of the Li atom in terms of spatial orbitals”

Solution

$$\chi_1 = \alpha\psi_1 \quad \chi_2 = \beta\psi_1 \quad \chi_3 = \alpha\psi_2$$

$$E_{\text{HF}} = 2h_{11} + h_{22} + J_{11} + 2J_{12} - K_{12}$$

Problem: HF energy of the B atom

“Find the HF energy of the B atom in terms of spatial orbitals”

Solution

$$E_{\text{HF}} = 2h_{11} + 2h_{22} + h_{33} + J_{11} + 4J_{12} + J_{22} - 2K_{12} + 2J_{13} + 2J_{23} - K_{13} - K_{23}$$

The Fock operator

Hartree-Fock Lagrangian

We would like to minimize E_{HF} with the constraint that the spin orbitals remain orthonormal:

$$\mathcal{L}[\{\chi_i\}] = E_{\text{HF}}[\{\chi_i\}] - \sum_{ij} \underbrace{\epsilon_{ji}}_{\text{Lagrange multipliers}} \underbrace{(\langle \chi_i | \chi_j \rangle - \delta_{ij})}_{\text{orthonormality constraint}}$$

The **stationarity of the HF Lagrangian** with respect to the spin orbitals implies that

$$\frac{\delta \mathcal{L}}{\delta \chi_i^*(\mathbf{x})} = 0 \quad \Rightarrow \quad \boxed{\hat{f}(\mathbf{x}) \chi_i(\mathbf{x}) = \sum_j \epsilon_{ji} \chi_j(\mathbf{x})}$$

One-electron Fock operator

$$\boxed{\hat{f}(\mathbf{x}) = \hat{h}(\mathbf{x}) + \underbrace{\sum_i^N [\hat{J}_i(\mathbf{x}) - \hat{K}_i(\mathbf{x})]}_{\hat{v}^{\text{HF}}(\mathbf{x}) = \text{Hartree-Fock potential}}}$$

Canonical Hartree-Fock equations

There exists a **unitary** transformation $\mathbf{U}$ such that $\tilde{\epsilon} = \mathbf{U}^\dagger \cdot \epsilon \cdot \mathbf{U}$ is **diagonal**:

$$\tilde{\chi}_i(\mathbf{x}) = \sum_j \chi_j(\mathbf{x}) U_{ji} \Rightarrow |\tilde{\Psi}_{\text{HF}}\rangle = \det(\mathbf{U}) |\Psi_{\text{HF}}\rangle = e^{i\theta} |\Psi_{\text{HF}}\rangle \quad \text{and} \quad \boxed{\tilde{f}(\mathbf{x}) = \hat{f}(\mathbf{x})}$$

$$\mathbf{U}^\dagger \cdot \mathbf{U} = \mathbf{1} \Rightarrow \det(\mathbf{U}^\dagger \cdot \mathbf{U}) = 1 \Rightarrow |\det(\mathbf{U})|^2 = 1 \Rightarrow \det(\mathbf{U}) = e^{i\theta}$$

Canonical HF equations

Dropping the tildes from hereon, we get

$$\boxed{\hat{f}(\mathbf{x}_1) \chi_i(\mathbf{x}) = \epsilon_i \chi_i(\mathbf{x})}$$

- Eigenfunctions $\{\chi_i\}$ are called **canonical spin orbitals**
- Eigenvalues $\{\epsilon_i\}$ are called **orbital energies**

Problem:

“ Find the expression of the matrix elements $f_{ij} = \langle \chi_i | \hat{f} | \chi_j \rangle$ ”

Fock matrix elements in the spin orbital basis

Problem:

“ Find the expression of the matrix elements $f_{ij} = \langle \chi_i | \hat{f} | \chi_j \rangle$ ”

Solution

$$\begin{aligned}\langle \chi_i | \hat{f} | \chi_j \rangle &= \langle \chi_i | \hat{h} + \sum_k \left(\hat{\mathcal{J}}_k - \hat{\mathcal{K}}_k \right) | \chi_j \rangle \\ &= \langle \chi_i | \hat{h} | \chi_j \rangle + \sum_k \left(\langle \chi_i | \hat{\mathcal{J}}_k | \chi_j \rangle - \langle \chi_i | \hat{\mathcal{K}}_k | \chi_j \rangle \right) \\ &= \langle i | \hat{h} | j \rangle + \sum_k [\langle ik | jk \rangle - \langle ik | kj \rangle] \\ &= \langle i | \hat{h} | j \rangle + \sum_k \langle ik || jk \rangle\end{aligned}$$

Problem:

“Deduce the expression of ϵ_i ”

Problem:

“Deduce the expression of ϵ_i ”

Solution

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{f}|\chi_i\rangle &= \epsilon_i |\chi_i\rangle \Rightarrow \langle\chi_i|\hat{f}|\chi_i\rangle = \epsilon_i \langle\chi_i|\chi_i\rangle = \epsilon_i \\ \Rightarrow \epsilon_i &= \langle i|\hat{h}|i\rangle + \sum_k [\langle ik|ik\rangle - \langle ik|ki\rangle] \\ \Rightarrow \epsilon_i &= \langle i|\hat{h}|i\rangle + \sum_k \langle ik||ik\rangle\end{aligned}$$

Koopmans' theorem

Ground-state energy of the N -electron system

$${}^N E_0 = \sum_i h_{ii} + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{ij} \langle ij || ij \rangle$$

Energy of the $(N - 1)$ -electron system (cation)

$${}^{N-1} E_k = \sum_{i \neq k} h_{ii} + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i \neq k} \sum_{j \neq k} \langle ij || ij \rangle$$

Ionization potential (IP)

$$\begin{aligned} \text{IP} &\approx {}^{N-1} E_k - {}^N E_0 \\ &= -\langle k | \hat{h} | k \rangle - \frac{1}{2} \sum_i \langle ik || ik \rangle - \frac{1}{2} \sum_j \langle kj || kj \rangle \\ &= -\langle k | \hat{h} | k \rangle - \sum_i \langle ik || ik \rangle = -\epsilon_k \end{aligned}$$

Koopmans' theorem for electron affinity (EA)

Problem:

“Show that Koopmans' theorem applies to electron affinities”

Koopmans' theorem for electron affinity (EA)

Problem:

“Show that Koopmans' theorem applies to electron affinities”

Solution

$$\begin{aligned} \text{EA} &\approx {}^N E_0 - {}^{N+1} E^c \\ &= -\langle c | \hat{h} | c \rangle - \sum_i \langle ci || ci \rangle \\ &= -\epsilon_c \end{aligned}$$

Ionization potentials

$$\begin{aligned}\text{IP} &= E_{\text{exact}}^{N-1} - E_{\text{exact}}^N \\ &= E_{\text{HF}}^{N-1} - E_{\text{HF}}^N + E_{\text{corr}}^{N-1} - E_{\text{corr}}^N \\ &= -\epsilon_i + \underbrace{\Delta_{\text{relax}}^{N-1}}_{<0} + \underbrace{\Delta_{\text{corr}}}_{>0}\end{aligned}$$

✓ Relaxation and correlation
partially cancel

Electron affinities

$$\begin{aligned}\text{EA} &= E_{\text{exact}}^N - E_{\text{exact}}^{N+1} \\ &= E_{\text{HF}}^N - E_{\text{HF}}^{N+1} + E_{\text{corr}}^N - E_{\text{corr}}^{N+1} \\ &= -\epsilon_a + \underbrace{\Delta_{\text{relax}}^{N+1}}_{>0} + \underbrace{\Delta_{\text{corr}}}_{>0}\end{aligned}$$

✗ Relaxation and correlation
do not cancel

⇒ Koopmans' theorem is usually more accurate for IPs than for EAs

Definition

$$\underbrace{\hat{\mathcal{H}}^{\text{HF}}}_{N\text{-electron operator}} = \sum_i^N \underbrace{\hat{f}(\mathbf{x}_i)}_{\text{one-electron operator}} = \sum_i^N \left[\hat{h}(\mathbf{x}_i) + \hat{v}^{\text{HF}}(\mathbf{x}_i) \right]$$

Warnings!

$$\hat{\mathcal{H}}^{\text{HF}} |\Psi_{\text{HF}}\rangle = \left(\sum_i^N \epsilon_i \right) |\Psi_{\text{HF}}\rangle \neq E_{\text{HF}} |\Psi_{\text{HF}}\rangle$$

The HF wavefunction is an eigenfunction of the HF Hamiltonian, but the eigenvalue is **not** the HF energy!

$$\hat{\mathcal{H}} |\Psi_{\text{HF}}\rangle \neq E_{\text{HF}} |\Psi_{\text{HF}}\rangle$$

The HF wavefunction is **not** an eigenfunction of the electronic Hamiltonian!

$$\langle \Psi_{\text{HF}} | \hat{\mathcal{H}}_{\text{elec}} | \Psi_{\text{HF}} \rangle = E_{\text{HF}}$$

The HF energy is the expectation value of the HF wavefunction of the electronic Hamiltonian

Double counting

$$\sum_i^N \epsilon_i = \sum_i^N h_{ii} + \sum_{ij}^N (\mathcal{J}_{ij} - \mathcal{K}_{ij})$$

⚡

$$E_{\text{HF}} = \sum_i^N h_{ii} + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{ij}^N (\mathcal{J}_{ij} - \mathcal{K}_{ij})$$

One double-counts the electron-electron interaction!

$$\langle \Psi_{\text{HF}} | \sum_{i < j} \frac{1}{r_{ij}} - \sum_i^N v^{\text{HF}}(\mathbf{x}_i) | \Psi_{\text{HF}} \rangle = -\frac{1}{2} \sum_{ij}^N (\mathcal{J}_{ij} - \mathcal{K}_{ij})$$

This is the first-order correction in **Møller-Plesset perturbation theory**!

Roothaan-Hall equations: introduction of a basis

Expansion in a basis

$$\psi_i(\mathbf{r}) = \sum_{\mu}^K C_{\mu i} \phi_{\mu}(\mathbf{r}) \quad \equiv \quad |i\rangle = \sum_{\mu}^K C_{\mu i} |\mu\rangle$$

Roothaan-Hall equations

$$\hat{f} |i\rangle = \epsilon_i |i\rangle \quad \Rightarrow \quad \hat{f} \sum_{\nu} C_{\nu i} |\nu\rangle = \epsilon_i \sum_{\nu} C_{\nu i} |\nu\rangle$$

$$\xRightarrow{\langle \mu |} \sum_{\nu} C_{\nu i} \underbrace{\langle \mu | \hat{f} | \nu \rangle}_{F_{\mu \nu}} = \epsilon_i \sum_{\nu} C_{\nu i} \underbrace{\langle \mu | \nu \rangle}_{S_{\mu \nu}}$$

$$\Rightarrow \boxed{\sum_{\nu} F_{\mu \nu} C_{\nu i} = \sum_{\nu} S_{\mu \nu} C_{\nu i} \epsilon_i} \quad \Rightarrow \quad \mathbf{F} \cdot \mathbf{C} = \mathbf{S} \cdot \mathbf{C} \cdot \mathbf{E} \quad \text{in matrix form}$$

The Roothaan-Hall matrix equations

Matrix form of the Roothaan-Hall equations

$$\mathbf{F} \cdot \mathbf{C} = \mathbf{S} \cdot \mathbf{C} \cdot \mathbf{E}$$

$$\Leftrightarrow$$

$$\mathbf{F}' \cdot \mathbf{C}' = \mathbf{C}' \cdot \mathbf{E}$$

$$\mathbf{F}' = \mathbf{X}^\dagger \cdot \mathbf{F} \cdot \mathbf{X}$$

$$\mathbf{C} = \mathbf{X} \cdot \mathbf{C}'$$

$$\mathbf{X}^\dagger \cdot \mathbf{S} \cdot \mathbf{X} = \mathbf{1}$$

- **Fock matrix** $F_{\mu\nu} = \langle \mu | \hat{f} | \nu \rangle$ and **overlap matrix** $S_{\mu\nu} = \langle \mu | \nu \rangle$
- We need to determine the **coefficient matrix** $\mathbf{C}$ and the **orbital energies** $\mathbf{E}$

$$\mathbf{C} = \begin{pmatrix} C_{11} & C_{12} & \cdots & C_{1K} \\ C_{21} & C_{22} & \cdots & C_{2K} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ C_{K1} & C_{K2} & \cdots & C_{KK} \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\mathbf{E} = \begin{pmatrix} \epsilon_1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ 0 & \epsilon_2 & \cdots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \cdots & \epsilon_K \end{pmatrix}$$

Self-consistent field (SCF) procedure

$$\mathbf{F}(\mathbf{C}) \cdot \mathbf{C} = \mathbf{S} \cdot \mathbf{C} \cdot \mathbf{E}$$

How do we solve these HF equations?

From generalized to standard

$$F \cdot C = \underbrace{S}_{\text{metric}} \cdot C \cdot E \Leftrightarrow \text{Generalized eigenvalue problem}$$

$\Downarrow$

$$X^\dagger \cdot F \cdot \underbrace{C}_{X \cdot C'} = X^\dagger \cdot S \cdot \underbrace{C}_{X \cdot C'} \cdot E$$

$\Downarrow$

$$\underbrace{X^\dagger \cdot F \cdot X}_{F'} \cdot C' = \underbrace{X^\dagger \cdot S \cdot X}_1 \cdot C' \cdot E$$

$\Downarrow$

$$F' \cdot C' = C' \cdot E \Leftrightarrow \text{Standard eigenvalue problem}$$

Expression of the Fock matrix

Problem:

“Find the expression of the Fock matrix in terms of the one- and two-electron integrals”

Expression of the Fock matrix

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“Find the expression of the Fock matrix in terms of the one- and two-electron integrals”

Solution

$$\begin{aligned}F_{\mu\nu} &= \langle \mu | \hat{h} + \sum_i^N (\hat{\mathcal{J}}_i - \hat{\mathcal{K}}_i) | \nu \rangle = \underbrace{\langle \mu | \hat{h} | \nu \rangle}_{H_{\mu\nu}} + \sum_i^N \langle \mu | \hat{\mathcal{J}}_i - \hat{\mathcal{K}}_i | \nu \rangle \\&= H_{\mu\nu} + \sum_i^N \left(\langle \mu \chi_i | r_{12}^{-1} | \nu \chi_i \rangle - \langle \mu \chi_i | r_{12}^{-1} | \chi_i \nu \rangle \right) \\&= H_{\mu\nu} + \sum_i^N \sum_{\lambda\sigma} C_{\lambda i} C_{\sigma i}^* \left(\langle \mu \sigma | r_{12}^{-1} | \nu \lambda \rangle - \langle \mu \sigma | r_{12}^{-1} | \lambda \nu \rangle \right) \\&= H_{\mu\nu} + \sum_{\lambda\sigma} P_{\lambda\sigma} (\langle \mu \sigma | \nu \lambda \rangle - \langle \mu \sigma | \lambda \nu \rangle) \\&= H_{\mu\nu} + \underbrace{\sum_{\lambda\sigma} P_{\lambda\sigma} \langle \mu \sigma || \nu \lambda \rangle}_{G_{\mu\nu}} = H_{\mu\nu} + G_{\mu\nu}\end{aligned}$$

Core Hamiltonian

$$H_{\mu\nu} = \langle \mu | \hat{h} | \nu \rangle$$

Density matrix

$$P_{\lambda\sigma} = \sum_i^N C_{\lambda i} C_{\sigma i}^*$$

Two-electron part

$$G_{\mu\nu} = \sum_{\lambda\sigma} P_{\lambda\sigma} \langle \mu \sigma || \nu \lambda \rangle$$

Expression of the HF energy

Problem:

“Find the expression of the HF energy in terms of the one- and two-electron integrals”

Expression of the HF energy

Problem:

“Find the expression of the HF energy in terms of the one- and two-electron integrals”

Solution

$$\begin{aligned} E_{\text{HF}} &= \sum_i^N h_{ii} + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{ij}^N (\mathcal{J}_{ij} - \mathcal{K}_{ij}) \\ &= \sum_i^N \left\langle \sum_{\mu} C_{\mu i}^* \phi_{\mu} \left| \hat{h} \right| \sum_{\nu} C_{\nu i} \phi_{\nu} \right\rangle + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{ij}^N \left\langle \left(\sum_{\mu} C_{\mu i}^* \phi_{\mu} \right) \left(\sum_{\lambda} C_{\lambda j}^* \phi_{\lambda} \right) \middle| \left(\sum_{\nu} C_{\nu i} \phi_{\nu} \right) \left(\sum_{\sigma} C_{\sigma j} \phi_{\sigma} \right) \right\rangle \\ &= \sum_{\mu\nu} P_{\nu\mu} \left(H_{\mu\nu} + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{\lambda\sigma} P_{\sigma\lambda} \langle \mu\lambda || \nu\sigma \rangle \right) \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \sum_{\mu\nu} P_{\nu\mu} (H_{\mu\nu} + F_{\mu\nu}) = \frac{1}{2} \text{Tr} [\mathbf{P} \cdot (\mathbf{H} + \mathbf{F})] \end{aligned}$$

Computation of the Fock matrix and energy

Density matrix (closed-shell system)

$$P_{\mu\nu} = 2 \sum_{i=1}^{N/2} C_{\mu i} C_{\nu i}^* \quad \text{or} \quad \boxed{P = 2C_o \cdot C_o^\dagger}$$

Fock matrix in the AO basis (closed-shell system)

$$F_{\mu\nu} = H_{\mu\nu} + \underbrace{\sum_{\lambda\sigma} P_{\sigma\lambda} (\mu\nu|\lambda\sigma)}_{J_{\mu\nu} = \text{Coulomb}} - \underbrace{\frac{1}{2} \sum_{\lambda\sigma} P_{\sigma\lambda} (\mu\sigma|\lambda\nu)}_{K_{\mu\nu} = \text{exchange}}$$

HF energy in the AO basis (closed-shell system)

$$E_{\text{HF}} = \sum_{\mu\nu} P_{\nu\mu} H_{\mu\nu} + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{\mu\nu\lambda\sigma} P_{\nu\mu} \left[(\mu\nu|\lambda\sigma) - \frac{1}{2} (\mu\sigma|\lambda\nu) \right] P_{\sigma\lambda}$$

The SCF algorithm

1. Specify molecule $\{\mathbf{R}_A\}$ and $\{Z_A\}$ and basis set $\{\phi_\mu\}$
2. Calculate integrals $S_{\mu\nu}$, $H_{\mu\nu}$ and $\langle\mu\nu|\lambda\sigma\rangle$
3. Diagonalize $\mathbf{S}$ and compute $\mathbf{X}$
4. Choose an initial density matrix $\mathbf{P}$
 1. Calculate $\mathbf{G}$ and then $\mathbf{F} = \mathbf{H} + \mathbf{G}$
 2. Compute $\mathbf{F}' = \mathbf{X}^\dagger \cdot \mathbf{F} \cdot \mathbf{X}$
 3. Diagonalize $\mathbf{F}'$ to obtain $\mathbf{C}'$ and $\mathbf{E}$
 4. Calculate $\mathbf{C} = \mathbf{X} \cdot \mathbf{C}'$
 5. Form a new density matrix $\mathbf{P} = 2\mathbf{C}_0 \cdot \mathbf{C}_0^\dagger$
 6. Am I converged? If not go back to 1.
5. Evaluate the desired observables, including E_{HF}

Orthogonalization matrix

We seek a matrix that orthogonalizes the AO basis, i.e., $\mathbf{X}^\dagger \cdot \mathbf{S} \cdot \mathbf{X} = \mathbf{1}$

Symmetric (or Löwdin) orthogonalization

$$\mathbf{X} = \mathbf{S}^{-1/2} = \mathbf{U} \cdot \mathbf{s}^{-1/2} \cdot \mathbf{U}^\dagger \text{ is one solution}$$

Is it working?

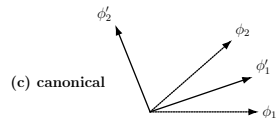
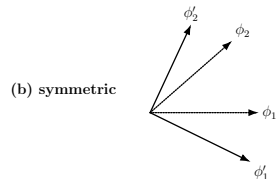
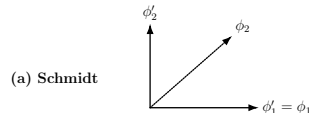
$$\mathbf{X}^\dagger \cdot \mathbf{S} \cdot \mathbf{X} = \mathbf{S}^{-1/2} \cdot \mathbf{S} \cdot \mathbf{S}^{-1/2} = \mathbf{1} \quad \checkmark$$

Canonical orthogonalization

$\mathbf{X} = \mathbf{U} \cdot \mathbf{s}^{-1/2}$ is another solution, useful when linear dependencies are present

Is it working?

$$\mathbf{X}^\dagger \cdot \mathbf{S} \cdot \mathbf{X} = \mathbf{s}^{-1/2} \cdot \underbrace{\mathbf{U}^\dagger \cdot \mathbf{S} \cdot \mathbf{U}}_{\mathbf{s}} \cdot \mathbf{s}^{-1/2} = \mathbf{1} \quad \checkmark$$



How to obtain a good guess for the MOs or density matrix?

Possible initial density matrix

1. We can set $\mathbf{P} = \mathbf{0} \Rightarrow \mathbf{F} = \mathbf{H}$ (core guess):
 $\Rightarrow$ Usually a poor guess but easy to implement
2. Use extended Hückel theory or a semi-empirical method:
 $\Rightarrow$ Inexpensive, though now less common
3. Use tabulated atomic densities:
 $\Rightarrow$ Superposition-of-atomic-densities (SAD) guess
4. Read the MOs of a previous calculation:
 $\Rightarrow$ Very common and very useful

How do I know I have converged (or not)?

The SCF procedure defines an iterative map

$$P^{(n)} \longrightarrow F[P^{(n)}] \longrightarrow P^{(n+1)}$$

At convergence,

$$P^{(n+1)} = P^{(n)} = P^\star$$

1. One can check the **energy and/or the density matrix**
2. At self-consistency, the **generalized commutator** vanishes:

$$e^{(n)} = F^{(n)} \cdot P^{(n)} \cdot S - S \cdot P^{(n)} \cdot F^{(n)}$$

$$P^{(n)} = P^\star \quad \implies \quad e^{(n)} = 0 \quad \implies \quad \max |e^{(n)}| < \tau_{\text{SCF}}$$

3. **DIIS (direct inversion in the iterative subspace)** is usually used to speed up convergence:

$\implies$ **Extrapolation of the Fock matrix** using the m previous iterations:

$$F^{(n+1)} = \sum_{i=n-m}^n c_i F^{(i)}$$

How does DIIS work?

Using the m stored iterations, DIIS constructs

$$\mathbf{F}_{\text{DIIS}}^{(m+1)} = \sum_{i=1}^m c_i \mathbf{F}^{(i)}$$

$$\mathbf{e}_{\text{DIIS}}^{(m+1)} \approx \sum_{i=1}^m c_i \mathbf{e}^{(i)}$$

The coefficients minimize the residual norm:

$$\boxed{\min_{\mathbf{c}} \left\| \sum_{i=1}^m c_i \mathbf{e}^{(i)} \right\|_F^2 \quad \text{subject to} \quad \sum_{i=1}^m c_i = 1}$$

Define the DIIS overlap matrix

$$B_{ij} = \langle \mathbf{e}^{(i)} | \mathbf{e}^{(j)} \rangle = \text{Tr} \left[\mathbf{e}^{(i)\dagger} \cdot \mathbf{e}^{(j)} \right]$$

Then

$$\left\| \mathbf{e}_{\text{DIIS}}^{(m+1)} \right\|_F^2 = \sum_{ij} c_i B_{ij} c_j = \mathbf{c}^T \cdot \mathbf{B} \cdot \mathbf{c}$$

DIIS weights and extrapolated Fock matrix

DIIS Lagrangian

$$\mathcal{L}(\mathbf{c}, \lambda) = \mathbf{c}^\top \cdot \mathbf{B} \cdot \mathbf{c} - 2\lambda \left(\sum_{i=1}^m c_i - 1 \right)$$

Stationarity conditions

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}(\mathbf{c}, \lambda)}{\partial \mathbf{c}} = \mathbf{0} \quad \text{and} \quad \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}(\mathbf{c}, \lambda)}{\partial \lambda} = 0 \quad \Rightarrow \quad \mathbf{B} \cdot \mathbf{c} - \lambda \mathbf{1} = \mathbf{0} \quad \text{and} \quad \sum_{i=1}^m c_i = 1$$

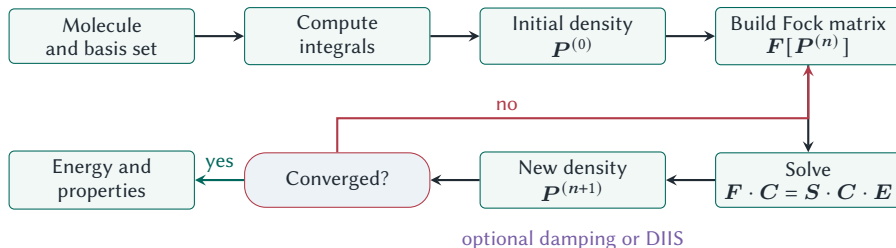
DIIS linear system

$$\begin{pmatrix} B_{11} & \cdots & B_{1m} & -1 \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots & \vdots \\ B_{m1} & \cdots & B_{mm} & -1 \\ -1 & \cdots & -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \cdot \begin{pmatrix} c_1 \\ \vdots \\ c_m \\ \lambda \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix} \Rightarrow \boxed{\mathbf{F}_{\text{DIIS}}^{(m+1)} = \sum_{i=1}^m c_i \mathbf{F}^{(i)}}$$

$\Rightarrow$ The linear system has dimension only $(m+1) \times (m+1)$

DIIS algorithm

1. Start from the current density $P^{(n)}$
2. Build the corresponding Fock matrix $F^{(n)} = F[P^{(n)}]$
3. Evaluate the commutator residual $e^{(n)} = F^{(n)} \cdot P^{(n)} \cdot S - S \cdot P^{(n)} \cdot F^{(n)}$
4. Store the pair $\{F^{(n)}, e^{(n)}\}$ and update the DIIS subspace
5. Construct B , solve the augmented linear system, and obtain the coefficients $\{c_i\}$
6. Extrapolate the Fock matrix $F^{\text{DIIS}} = \sum_i c_i F^{(i)}$
7. Solve $F^{\text{DIIS}} \cdot C = S \cdot C \cdot E$ and form the next density $P^{(n+1)}$

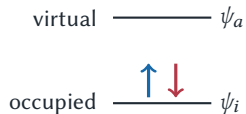


- **Key idea:** DIIS accelerates SCF convergence by finding a linear combination of previous Fock matrices whose extrapolated residual is minimal
- ✓ A small **rolling subspace** is normally sufficient: commonly $m \approx 6-10$
- ✗ DIIS requires additional **storage**: $\sim 2mK^2$
- ✗ The extrapolated energy is not guaranteed to decrease monotonically
- ✗ B can be **singular** due to nearly linear dependence of the residuals: a restart may be required
- ✓ DIIS can be used for many other methods!

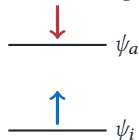
Variational collapse

An excited determinant can be generated by promoting one or more electrons, but the usual Aufbau occupation does not preserve that configuration.

Ground-state orbitals



Excited-state guess



Aufbau SCF



Variational collapse



The problem

After each diagonalization, Aufbau occupies the **lowest-energy** orbitals
⇒ **the SCF tends to return to a lower-energy solution**

Maximum overlap method (MOM)

Let C_o^{ref} contain the coefficients of the occupied reference spin orbitals defining the target configuration.

$$\forall \chi_p^{\text{new}} \quad \text{compute} \quad O_{ip} = \left\langle \chi_i^{\text{ref}} \left| \chi_p^{\text{new}} \right. \right\rangle = \sum_{\mu\nu} C_{\mu i}^{\text{ref}*} S_{\mu\nu} C_{\nu p}^{\text{new}} \quad \text{and} \quad \boxed{w_p = \sum_{i \in O_{\text{ref}}} |O_{ip}|^2}$$

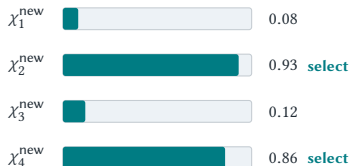
MOM procedure

- Compute w_p for every new orbital
- Occupy the N spin orbitals with the **largest w_p**
- In MOM, the reference occupied space comes from the previous iteration
- In **IMOM**, the reference orbitals remain fixed to the initial guess

Occupied reference space

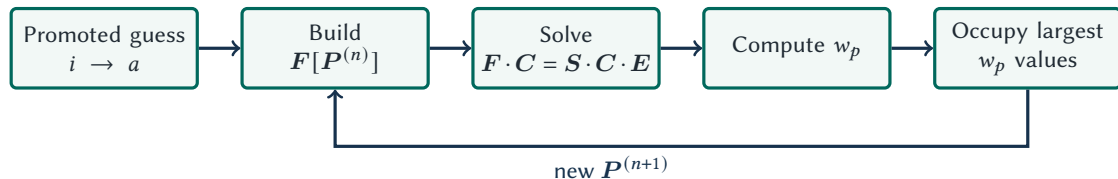
$$O_{\text{ref}} = \text{span}\{\chi_i^{\text{ref}}\}$$

overlap with O_{ref}



Select by orbital character, not by energy!

MOM-based SCF



Conventional SCF

Occupy the lowest orbital energies

$$\epsilon_1 \leq \epsilon_2 \leq \dots \leq \epsilon_N$$

$\Rightarrow$ finds a low-energy solution

MOM-SCF

Occupy the largest w values

$$w_1 \geq w_2 \geq \dots \geq w_N$$

$\Rightarrow$ follows a chosen SCF solution

MOM changes the occupation to target non-Aufbau stationary solutions of the HF equations

What does a MOM calculation give?

What is gained?

- ✓ A higher-energy stationary solution of the HF equations
- ✓ Useful excitation energies for states dominated by a single electronic configuration
- ✓ Full orbital relaxation for the targeted configuration
- ✓ A state-specific density and molecular properties
- ✓ The same formal cost per SCF iteration, although convergence may be more difficult

What are the cautions?

- ✗ The result is still a single determinant
- ✗ Spin symmetry may be broken
- ✗ Different SCF states are not necessarily orthogonal
- ✗ Convergence depends on the initial promoted orbitals
- ✗ MOM can drift or converge to an unintended solution

Dipole moments

Classical vs Quantum

$$\boldsymbol{\mu} = (\mu_x, \mu_y, \mu_z) = \underbrace{\sum_i q_i \mathbf{r}_i}_{\text{classical definition}}$$

$$\boldsymbol{\mu} = (\mu_x, \mu_y, \mu_z) = \underbrace{\langle \Psi_0 | - \sum_i^N \mathbf{r}_i | \Psi_0 \rangle}_{\text{electrons}} + \underbrace{\sum_A^M Z_A \mathbf{R}_A}_{\text{nuclei}} = - \sum_{\mu\nu}^{\text{red}} P_{\mu\nu} \langle \nu | \mathbf{r} | \mu \rangle + \sum_A^{\text{blue}} Z_A \mathbf{R}_A$$

Vector components

$$\mu_x = - \sum_{\mu\nu}^{\text{red}} P_{\mu\nu} \langle \nu | x | \mu \rangle + \sum_A^{\text{blue}} Z_A X_A \quad \text{with} \quad \underbrace{\langle \nu | x | \mu \rangle}_{\text{one-electron integrals}} = \int \phi_\nu^*(\mathbf{r}) x \phi_\mu(\mathbf{r}) d\mathbf{r}$$

Charge analysis

Electron density

$$\rho(\mathbf{r}) = \sum_{\mu\nu} \phi_{\mu}(\mathbf{r}) P_{\mu\nu} \phi_{\nu}^*(\mathbf{r}) \quad \text{with} \quad \int \rho(\mathbf{r}) d\mathbf{r} = N \quad \Rightarrow \quad N = \sum_{\mu\nu} P_{\mu\nu} S_{\nu\mu} = \sum_{\mu} (\mathbf{P} \cdot \mathbf{S})_{\mu\mu} = \text{Tr}(\mathbf{P} \cdot \mathbf{S})$$

Mulliken population analysis

Assuming that the basis functions are atom-centered

$$\underbrace{q_A^{\text{Mulliken}}}_{\text{net charge on } A} = Z_A - \sum_{\mu \in A} (\mathbf{P} \cdot \mathbf{S})_{\mu\mu}$$

Löwdin population analysis

Because $\text{Tr}(\mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{B}) = \text{Tr}(\mathbf{B} \cdot \mathbf{A})$, we have, for any α , $N = \sum_{\mu} (\mathbf{S}^{\alpha} \cdot \mathbf{P} \cdot \mathbf{S}^{1-\alpha})_{\mu\mu}$

$$\text{For } \alpha = 1/2, \text{ we get: } N = \sum_{\mu} (\mathbf{S}^{1/2} \cdot \mathbf{P} \cdot \mathbf{S}^{1/2})_{\mu\mu} \quad \Rightarrow \quad q_A^{\text{Löwdin}} = Z_A - \sum_{\mu \in A} (\mathbf{S}^{1/2} \cdot \mathbf{P} \cdot \mathbf{S}^{1/2})_{\mu\mu}$$

Localized orbitals

$$\tilde{C}_0 = \underbrace{C_0}_{\text{occupied orbitals}} \cdot U \quad U^\dagger \cdot U = 1 \quad \Leftrightarrow \quad \text{unitary transformation}$$

The density matrix is unchanged

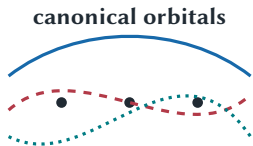
For a closed-shell determinant,

$$\tilde{P} = 2\tilde{C}_0 \cdot \tilde{C}_0^\dagger = 2C_0 \cdot C_0^\dagger = P$$

The determinant changes only by a phase

$$|\tilde{\Psi}_0\rangle = \det(U) |\Psi_0\rangle$$

The **density**, **energy**, and **every expectation value** are unchanged



unitary transformation



- Only **occupied-occupied** or **virtual-virtual** rotations are invariant
- Mixing **occupied and virtual** orbitals changes the wavefunction and the energy
- Localization functionals are generally **nonconvex**: different guesses may converge to different local extrema

Localization procedures

Edmiston-Ruedenberg functional

$$\Omega_{\text{ER}} = \sum_i (\psi_i \psi_i | \psi_i \psi_i) \longrightarrow \text{max orbital self-repulsion}$$

Foster-Boys functional

$$\begin{aligned} \Omega_{\text{BF}} &= \frac{1}{2} \sum_i [\langle \psi_i \psi_i | r_{12}^2 | \psi_i \psi_i \rangle] \longrightarrow \text{min spatial extent} \\ &\equiv \sum_i [\langle \psi_i | r^2 | \psi_i \rangle - |\langle \psi_i | \mathbf{r} | \psi_i \rangle|^2] \longrightarrow \text{max distance between centroids} \end{aligned}$$

Strengths

- ✓ Requires only one-electron integrals
- ✓ Produces compact bonds and lone pairs

Limitations

- ✗ Does not explicitly preserve σ/π separation
- ✗ Diffuse virtual orbitals may be difficult to localize

Pipek-Mezey localization procedure

For an atomic population q_i^A of orbital i on atom A , the original Pipek-Mezey criterion maximizes

$$\Omega_{\text{PM}} = \sum_A \sum_i |q_i^A|^2$$

using Mulliken populations

$$q_i^A = \sum_{\mu \in A} \sum_v C_{\mu i}^* S_{\mu v} C_{v i}$$

Strengths

- ✓ Often preserves separation between σ and π orbitals
- ✓ Produces intuitive bonds, lone pairs, and core orbitals

Limitations

- ✗ The original Mulliken form can be basis set dependent
- ✗ Löwdin populations or intrinsic atomic orbitals provide more robust alternatives

There is no universally *best* localized orbital set: the criterion should match the intended interpretation or computational use

What remains unchanged

- The occupied subspace and Slater determinant
- The density matrix and electron density
- The HF energy and molecular properties
- The zero occupied-virtual Fock block

$$\tilde{f}_{ov} = f_{ov} = 0$$

Why localize?

- Identify bonds, lone pairs, and fragments
- Enable local correlation and embedding methods
- Select active spaces and domains
- Construct Wannier functions in periodic systems

What changes

- Localized orbitals are generally not eigenfunctions of the Fock operator:

$$\tilde{f}_{oo} = \mathbf{U}^\dagger \cdot \epsilon_o \cdot \mathbf{U}$$

- Orbital energies cannot therefore be assigned to localized orbitals

Practical cautions

- Localize occupied and virtual spaces separately
- Core and valence orbitals are often localized separately
- Check for multiple extrema and discontinuous solutions
- Spatial symmetry may be lost

How to model open-shell systems?

- For open-shell systems one uses **unrestricted spin orbitals**

$$\chi_p^{\text{UHF}}(\mathbf{x}) = \begin{cases} \alpha(\omega)\psi_p^\alpha(\mathbf{r}) \\ \beta(\omega)\psi_p^\beta(\mathbf{r}) \end{cases}$$

- UHF may break spin symmetry: the determinant need not be an eigenfunction of $\hat{S}^2$
- The HF wavefunction is no longer a pure spin function
- Singlets are contaminated by triplets, quintets, etc
- Doublets are contaminated by quartets, sextets, etc
- Generalized HF also allows spin mixing and need not preserve $\hat{S}_z$

$$\chi_p^{\text{GHF}}(\mathbf{x}) = \alpha(\omega)\psi_p^\alpha(\mathbf{r}) + \beta(\omega)\psi_p^\beta(\mathbf{r}) \Rightarrow \text{two-component spinor}$$

UHF equations for unrestricted spin orbitals

To minimize the UHF energy, the unrestricted spatial orbitals must be eigenfunctions of the α and β Fock operators:

$$f^\alpha(\mathbf{r}_1)\psi_i^\alpha(\mathbf{r}_1) = \epsilon_i^\alpha\psi_i^\alpha(\mathbf{r}_1)$$

$$f^\beta(\mathbf{r}_1)\psi_i^\beta(\mathbf{r}_1) = \epsilon_i^\beta\psi_i^\beta(\mathbf{r}_1)$$

where

$$f^\alpha(\mathbf{r}_1) = h(\mathbf{r}_1) + \sum_i^{N^\alpha} [J_i^\alpha(\mathbf{r}_1) - K_i^\alpha(\mathbf{r}_1)] + \sum_i^{N^\beta} J_i^\beta(\mathbf{r}_1)$$

$$f^\beta(\mathbf{r}_1) = h(\mathbf{r}_1) + \sum_i^{N^\beta} [J_i^\beta(\mathbf{r}_1) - K_i^\beta(\mathbf{r}_1)] + \sum_i^{N^\alpha} J_i^\alpha(\mathbf{r}_1)$$

The Coulomb and Exchange operators are

$$J_i^\sigma(\mathbf{r}_1) = \int \psi_i^{\sigma*}(\mathbf{r}_2) r_{12}^{-1} \psi_i^\sigma(\mathbf{r}_2) d\mathbf{r}_2$$

$$K_i^\sigma(\mathbf{r}_1)\psi_j^\sigma(\mathbf{r}_1) = \left[\int \psi_i^{\sigma*}(\mathbf{r}_2) r_{12}^{-1} \psi_j^\sigma(\mathbf{r}_2) d\mathbf{r}_2 \right] \psi_i^\sigma(\mathbf{r}_1)$$

The UHF energy

UHF energy

The UHF energy comprises three contributions:

$$E_{\text{UHF}} = E_{\text{UHF}}^{\alpha\alpha} + E_{\text{UHF}}^{\beta\beta} + E_{\text{UHF}}^{\alpha\beta}$$

which yields

$$E_{\text{UHF}} = \sum_i^{N^\alpha} h_{ii}^\alpha + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{ij}^{N^\alpha} (J_{ij}^{\alpha\alpha} - K_{ij}^{\alpha\alpha}) + \sum_i^{N^\beta} h_{ii}^\beta + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{ij}^{N^\beta} (J_{ij}^{\beta\beta} - K_{ij}^{\beta\beta}) + \sum_i^{N^\alpha} \sum_j^{N^\beta} J_{ij}^{\alpha\beta}$$

The matrix elements are given by

$$h_{ii}^\sigma = \langle \psi_i^\sigma | h | \psi_i^\sigma \rangle$$

$$J_{ij}^{\sigma\sigma'} = \langle \psi_i^\sigma \psi_j^{\sigma'} | \psi_i^\sigma \psi_j^{\sigma'} \rangle$$

$$K_{ij}^{\sigma\sigma} = \langle \psi_i^\sigma \psi_j^\sigma | \psi_j^\sigma \psi_i^\sigma \rangle$$

Note that **there is no exchange between opposite-spin electrons**

Problem

“Write down the UHF energy of the doublet state of the lithium atom”

Problem

“Write down the UHF energy of the doublet state of the lithium atom”

Solution

$$E_{\text{UHF}} = h_1^\alpha + h_1^\beta + h_2^\alpha + J_{12}^{\alpha\alpha} - K_{12}^{\alpha\alpha} + J_{11}^{\alpha\beta} + J_{21}^{\alpha\beta}$$

The Pople-Nesbet equations

Expansion of the unrestricted spin orbitals in a basis

$$\psi_i^\alpha(\mathbf{r}) = \sum_{\mu=1}^K C_{\mu i}^\alpha \phi_\mu(\mathbf{r})$$

$$\psi_i^\beta(\mathbf{r}) = \sum_{\mu=1}^K C_{\mu i}^\beta \phi_\mu(\mathbf{r})$$

The Pople-Nesbet equations

$$\mathbf{F}^\alpha \cdot \mathbf{C}^\alpha = \mathbf{S} \cdot \mathbf{C}^\alpha \cdot \mathbf{E}^\alpha$$

$$\mathbf{F}^\beta \cdot \mathbf{C}^\beta = \mathbf{S} \cdot \mathbf{C}^\beta \cdot \mathbf{E}^\beta$$

$$F_{\mu\nu}^\alpha = H_{\mu\nu} + \sum_{\lambda\sigma} P_{\lambda\sigma}^\alpha [(\mu\nu|\sigma\lambda) - (\mu\lambda|\sigma\nu)] + \sum_{\lambda\sigma} P_{\lambda\sigma}^\beta (\mu\nu|\sigma\lambda)$$

$$F_{\mu\nu}^\beta = H_{\mu\nu} + \sum_{\lambda\sigma} P_{\lambda\sigma}^\beta [(\mu\nu|\sigma\lambda) - (\mu\lambda|\sigma\nu)] + \sum_{\lambda\sigma} P_{\lambda\sigma}^\alpha (\mu\nu|\sigma\lambda)$$

$\mathbf{F}^\alpha$ and $\mathbf{F}^\beta$ are both functions of $\mathbf{C}^\alpha$ and $\mathbf{C}^\beta \Rightarrow$ There's a coupling between α and β orbitals!

Unrestricted Density Matrices

Spin-up and spin-down density matrices

$$P_{\mu\nu}^{\alpha} = \sum_{i=1}^{N^{\alpha}} C_{\mu i}^{\alpha} C_{\nu i}^{\alpha*} \Leftrightarrow \mathbf{P}^{\alpha}$$

$$P_{\mu\nu}^{\beta} = \sum_{i=1}^{N^{\beta}} C_{\mu i}^{\beta} C_{\nu i}^{\beta*} \Leftrightarrow \mathbf{P}^{\beta}$$

Properties of the density ($\sigma = \alpha$ or β)

$$\rho^{\sigma}(\mathbf{r}) = \sum_{\mu\nu} \phi_{\mu}(\mathbf{r}) P_{\mu\nu}^{\sigma} \phi_{\nu}^{*}(\mathbf{r})$$

$$\int \rho^{\sigma}(\mathbf{r}) d\mathbf{r} = N^{\sigma}$$

Total and Spin density matrices

$$\underbrace{P^{\text{T}}}_{\text{Charge density}} = \mathbf{P}^{\alpha} + \mathbf{P}^{\beta}$$

$$\underbrace{P^{\text{S}}}_{\text{Spin density}} = \mathbf{P}^{\alpha} - \mathbf{P}^{\beta}$$

How to perform a UHF calculation in practice

The SCF algorithm

1. Specify molecule $\{R_A\}$ and $\{Z_A\}$ and basis set $\{\phi_\mu\}$ (same as RHF)
2. Calculate integrals $S_{\mu\nu}$, $H_{\mu\nu}$ and $\langle\mu\nu|\lambda\sigma\rangle$ (same as RHF)
3. Diagonalize S and compute X (same as RHF)
4. Choose initial density matrices P^α and P^β
 - 1a. Calculate G^α and then $F^\alpha = H + G^\alpha$
 - 1b. Calculate G^β and then $F^\beta = H + G^\beta$
 2. Compute $(F^\alpha)' = X^\dagger \cdot F^\alpha \cdot X$ and $(F^\beta)' = X^\dagger \cdot F^\beta \cdot X$
 - 3a. Diagonalize $(F^\alpha)'$ to obtain $(C^\alpha)'$ and E^α
 - 3b. Diagonalize $(F^\beta)'$ to obtain $(C^\beta)'$ and E^β
 4. Calculate $C^\alpha = X \cdot (C^\alpha)'$ and $C^\beta = X \cdot (C^\beta)'$
 5. Form the new density matrices P^α and P^β , and compute $P^T = P^\alpha + P^\beta$
 6. Am I converged? If not go back to 1.
5. Evaluate the desired observables, including E_{UHF}

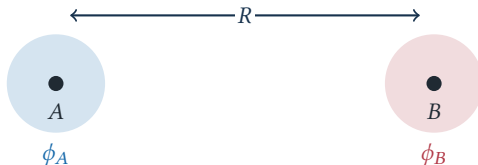
Hartree-Fock for minimal-basis H₂

Start from one normalized 1s function on each atom

$$\psi_g = \frac{\phi_A + \phi_B}{\sqrt{2(1+S)}} \quad \psi_u = \frac{\phi_A - \phi_B}{\sqrt{2(1-S)}} \quad \text{with} \quad S = \langle \phi_A | \phi_B \rangle$$

Why is it special?

For two electrons in two spatial orbitals, UHF reduces to a single-parameter problem



RHF wavefunction and energy

$$|\Psi_{\text{RHF}}\rangle = |\psi_g \bar{\psi}_g\rangle \quad \text{and} \quad E_{\text{RHF}} = 2h_{gg} + J_{gg} + \frac{1}{R}$$

At large R , where $S \rightarrow 0$,

$$\psi_g(1)\psi_g(2) \longrightarrow \frac{1}{2} \left[\underbrace{\phi_A(1)\phi_B(2) + \phi_B(1)\phi_A(2)}_{\text{covalent}} + \underbrace{\phi_A(1)\phi_A(2) + \phi_B(1)\phi_B(2)}_{\text{ionic}} \right]$$

The RHF dissociation error

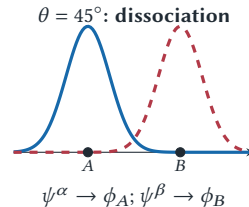
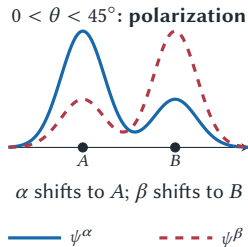
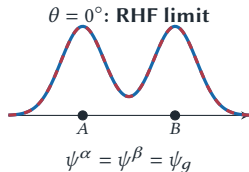
RHF retains **50% ionic character** at $R \rightarrow \infty$. Both electrons are forced to share the same spatial orbital, so the RHF energy lies above the energy of two separated H atoms

$\Rightarrow$ RHF is qualitatively correct near equilibrium but not at dissociation

UHF orbitals

$$\begin{aligned} \psi^\alpha(\theta) &= \cos \theta \psi_g + \sin \theta \psi_u \\ \psi^\beta(\theta) &= \cos \theta \psi_g - \sin \theta \psi_u \end{aligned} \quad \text{with} \quad \langle \psi^\alpha | \psi^\beta \rangle = \cos(2\theta)$$

The two choices $\pm\theta$ are degenerate and exchange the spin localization



UHF energy and stationary points

With $J_{pq} = (pp|qq)$ and $K_{pq} = (pq|pq)$,

$$E_{\text{UHF}}(\theta) = 2 \cos^2 \theta h_{gg} + 2 \sin^2 \theta h_{uu} + \cos^4 \theta J_{gg} + \sin^4 \theta J_{uu} + 2 \sin^2 \theta \cos^2 \theta (J_{gu} - 2K_{gu})$$

Besides the restricted stationary point $\theta = 0$, a **broken-symmetry stationary solution** satisfies

$$\cos^2 \theta^\star = \frac{h_{uu} - h_{gg} + J_{uu} - J_{gu} + 2K_{gu}}{J_{gg} + J_{uu} - 2J_{gu} + 4K_{gu}}$$

Short bond length

Only the minimum at $\theta = 0$ is physically accessible, and UHF reduces to RHF

Large bond length

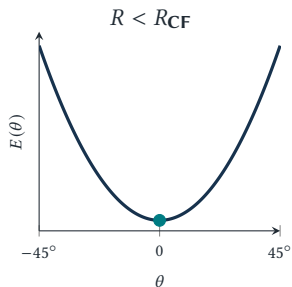
When $0 \leq \cos^2 \theta^\star \leq 1$, two minima appear at $\pm\theta^\star$, and RHF becomes unstable to spin polarization

Coulson-Fischer (CF) point

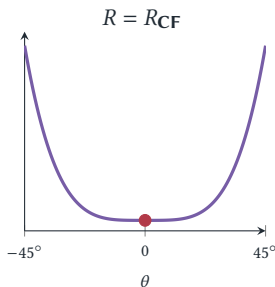
$$\left. \frac{d^2 E}{d\theta^2} \right|_{\theta=0} = 4 (h_{uu} - h_{gg} - J_{gg} + J_{gu} - 2K_{gu})$$

$$R = R_{\text{CF}} \iff \left. \frac{d^2 E}{d\theta^2} \right|_{\theta=0} = 0$$

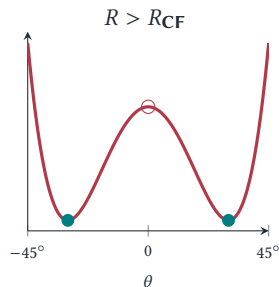
The Coulson-Fischer point



Positive RHF curvature
one minimum at $\theta = 0$



Vanishing RHF curvature
the minimum becomes flat

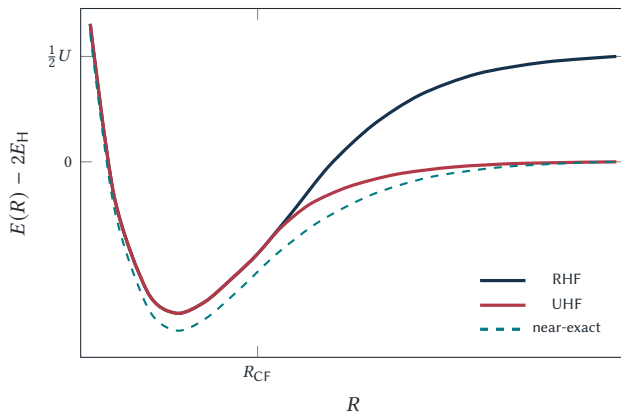


Negative RHF curvature
two UHF minima at $\pm\theta^*$

What changes at the Coulson-Fischer point?

The RHF determinant at $\theta = 0$ does not disappear: it changes from a minimum to an unstable stationary point while two degenerate UHF minima emerge at $\pm\theta^*$

Schematic dissociation curve



At $R \rightarrow \infty$,

$$S \rightarrow 0 \quad \psi_g \rightarrow \frac{\phi_A + \phi_B}{\sqrt{2}}$$

Define the positive on-site repulsion

$$U = (AA|AA)$$

Restricted limit

$$E_{\text{RHF}}^{\infty} = 2E_H + \frac{1}{2}U$$

The ionic terms leave a finite error

Unrestricted limit

Since $\psi^{\alpha} \rightarrow \phi_A$ and $\psi^{\beta} \rightarrow \phi_B$,

$$E_{\text{UHF}}^{\infty} = 2E_H$$

Symmetry-broken UHF

For the two-electron $M_S = 0$ determinant,

$$\langle \hat{S}^2 \rangle_{\text{UHF}} = 1 - \left| \langle \psi^\alpha | \psi^\beta \rangle \right|^2 = \sin^2(2\theta)$$

Near equilibrium

$\theta = 0$ and $\langle \hat{S}^2 \rangle = 0$: the determinant is a pure singlet

At dissociation

$\theta \rightarrow \pi/4$ and $\langle \hat{S}^2 \rangle \rightarrow 1$: the determinant is an equal mixture of singlet and $M_S = 0$ triplet

$$|A\alpha B\beta\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|\text{covalent singlet}\rangle + |\text{triplet}, M_S = 0\rangle) \quad \text{as } R \rightarrow \infty$$

$\Rightarrow$ The UHF energy is physically useful, but the UHF wavefunction is spin-contaminated

Three take-home messages

1. A stationary SCF solution need not be stable
2. The Coulson-Fischer point marks a continuous RHF to UHF transition
3. Symmetry breaking mimics static correlation at the price of a contaminated wavefunction

Key idea: GHF allows every orbital to choose its spin direction

A GHF orbital is a **two-component spinor**:

$$\chi_p^{\text{GHF}}(\mathbf{x}) = \alpha(\omega) \psi_p^\alpha(\mathbf{r}) + \beta(\omega) \psi_p^\beta(\mathbf{r})$$

Both components are expanded in the same spatial AO basis

$$\psi_i^\sigma(\mathbf{r}) = \sum_{\mu=1}^K C_{\mu i}^\sigma \phi_\mu(\mathbf{r}) \quad \text{with} \quad \mathbf{C} = \begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{C}^\alpha \\ \mathbf{C}^\beta \end{pmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad \mathbf{C} \in \mathbb{C}^{2K \times N}$$

RHF

Paired electrons share one spatial orbital: both $\hat{\mathbf{S}}^2$ and $\hat{\mathbf{S}}_z$ are preserved

UHF

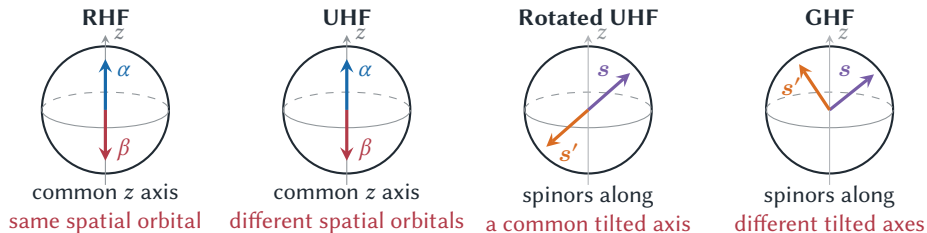
Each orbital is purely α or β : the spin density is collinear and $\hat{\mathbf{S}}_z$ is preserved

GHF

Each orbital may mix α and β : in general, neither $\hat{\mathbf{S}}^2$ nor $\hat{\mathbf{S}}_z$ is preserved

$\Rightarrow$ GHF does not require a common spin-quantization axis or fixed values of N^α and N^β

GHF allows arbitrary spin directions



Collinear vs non-collinear solutions

$$\underbrace{\text{UHF} \xrightarrow{\text{global spin rotation}} \text{rotated UHF}}_{\text{physically equivalent collinear solutions}} \neq \underbrace{\text{genuine GHF}}_{\text{non-collinear}} \quad (2)$$

$\Rightarrow$ A tilted spin axis alone does not imply a genuinely non-collinear GHF solution

Density matrix

$$\mathcal{P} = \begin{pmatrix} P^{\alpha\alpha} & P^{\alpha\beta} \\ P^{\beta\alpha} & P^{\beta\beta} \end{pmatrix} \quad \text{with} \quad P_{\mu\nu}^{\sigma\sigma'} = \sum_{i=1}^N C_{\mu i}^{\sigma} C_{\nu i}^{\sigma'*}$$

What do the blocks mean?

- $P = \frac{1}{2}(P^{\alpha\alpha} + P^{\beta\beta})$ determines the **charge density**
- $M_z = \frac{1}{2}(P^{\alpha\alpha} - P^{\beta\beta})$ gives the z component of **magnetization**
- $M_y = \frac{1}{2i}(P^{\beta\alpha} - P^{\alpha\beta})$ generates the transverse y component
- $M_x = \frac{1}{2}(P^{\beta\alpha} + P^{\alpha\beta})$ generates the transverse x component

$$\mathcal{P} = \begin{pmatrix} P + M_z & M_x - iM_y \\ M_x + iM_y & P - M_z \end{pmatrix} = P \otimes 1 + M \otimes \sigma \quad \text{with} \quad M = \begin{pmatrix} M_x \\ M_y \\ M_z \end{pmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad \sigma = \begin{pmatrix} \sigma_x \\ \sigma_y \\ \sigma_z \end{pmatrix}$$

GHF equations: Roothaan-Hall in spinor space

Generalized eigenvalue problem

$$\boxed{\mathcal{F} \cdot \mathbf{C} = \mathbf{S} \cdot \mathbf{C} \cdot \mathcal{E}} \quad \text{with} \quad \mathbf{S} = \begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{S} & 0 \\ 0 & \mathbf{S} \end{pmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad \mathbf{C}^\dagger \cdot \mathbf{S} \cdot \mathbf{C} = 1$$

Fock matrix

$$\boxed{\mathcal{F} = \begin{pmatrix} h + J[\mathbf{P}^{\alpha\alpha}] + J[\mathbf{P}^{\beta\beta}] - K[\mathbf{P}^{\alpha\alpha}] & -K[\mathbf{P}^{\alpha\beta}] \\ -K[\mathbf{P}^{\beta\alpha}] & h + J[\mathbf{P}^{\alpha\alpha}] + J[\mathbf{P}^{\beta\beta}] - K[\mathbf{P}^{\beta\beta}] \end{pmatrix}}$$

with

$$J_{\mu\nu}[\mathbf{P}] = \sum_{\lambda\sigma} P_{\lambda\sigma}(\mu\nu|\lambda\sigma)$$

$$K_{\mu\nu}[\mathbf{P}] = \sum_{\lambda\sigma} P_{\lambda\sigma}(\mu\sigma|\lambda\nu)$$

The off-diagonal exchange blocks couple the α and β components self-consistently

SCF procedure

Build all four density blocks $\rightarrow$ build all four Fock blocks $\rightarrow$ solve a $2K \times 2K$ generalized eigenvalue problem $\rightarrow$ occupy the N lowest spinors $\rightarrow$ iterate

$$\{\Phi_{\text{RHF}}\} \subset \{\Phi_{\text{UHF}}\} \subset \{\Phi_{\text{GHF}}\} \implies E_{\text{GHF}} \leq E_{\text{UHF}} \leq E_{\text{RHF}}$$

for the corresponding global minima in the same one-electron basis

A new stability direction

A converged UHF determinant may still be unstable to occupied-virtual rotations that mix α and β orbitals. Following such a negative-curvature direction produces a lower-energy GHF solution.

Not every GHF solution is noncollinear

RHF and UHF are special cases of GHF. A global spin rotation of a UHF determinant changes its apparent quantization axis but remains physically collinear.

Symmetry dilemma

Lowering the variational energy may require breaking exact symmetries:

- UHF may break $\hat{S}^2$
- GHF may break both $\hat{S}^2$ and $\hat{S}_z$
- Complex GHF may also break time-reversal symmetry

Interpret with care

- GHF is still a single determinant: correlation is not included
- S and M_S are generally not good quantum numbers
- Many stationary solutions make the initial guess important: **stability analysis**
- The GHF solution might be a globally rotated UHF solution: **collinearity test**
- **Equilateral H_3** and **triangular magnetic clusters** are typical examples of genuine noncollinearity

Take-home messages

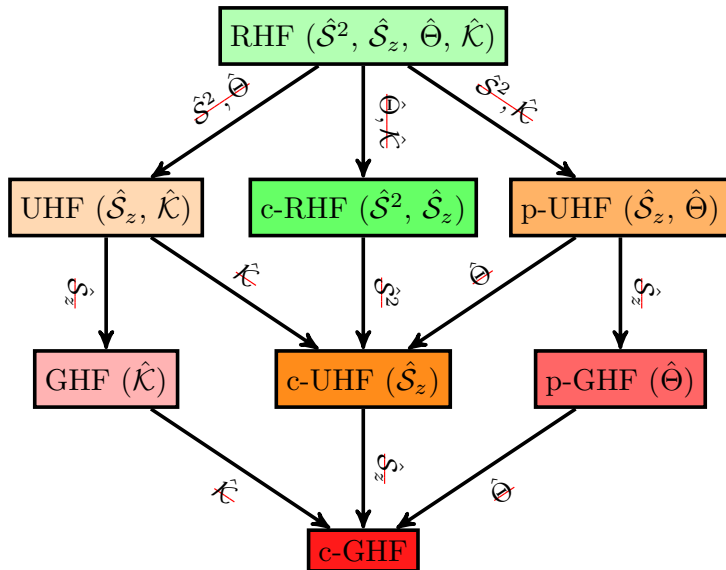
- GHF is the most general **number-conserving** single-determinant HF ansatz
- One can break particle-number symmetry within **Hartree-Fock-Bogoliubov (HFB)** theory

Stuber-Paldus classification of Hartree-Fock solutions

Fukutome designation	Stuber-Paldus designation	Symmetries preserved ⁱ	Structure of the orbital coefficient matrix C
TICS ^a	real RHF	$\hat{S}^2, \hat{S}_z, \hat{\mathcal{K}}, \hat{\Theta}$	$\begin{pmatrix} C_{\sigma\sigma} & 0 \\ 0 & C_{\sigma\sigma} \end{pmatrix}, \quad C \in \mathbb{R}$
CCW ^b	complex RHF	$\hat{S}^2, \hat{S}_z$	$\begin{pmatrix} C_{\sigma\sigma} & 0 \\ 0 & C_{\sigma\sigma} \end{pmatrix}$
ASCW ^c	paired UHF	$\hat{S}_z, \hat{\Theta}$	$\begin{pmatrix} C_{\sigma\sigma} & 0 \\ 0 & C_{\sigma\sigma}^* \end{pmatrix}$
ASDW ^d	real UHF	$\hat{S}_z, \hat{\mathcal{K}}$	$\begin{pmatrix} C_{\sigma\sigma} & 0 \\ 0 & C_{\sigma'\sigma'} \end{pmatrix}, \quad C \in \mathbb{R}$
ASW ^e	complex UHF	$\hat{S}_z$	$\begin{pmatrix} C_{\sigma\sigma} & 0 \\ 0 & C_{\sigma'\sigma'} \end{pmatrix}$
TSCW ^f	paired GHF	$\hat{\Theta}$	$\begin{pmatrix} C_{\sigma\sigma} & C_{\sigma\sigma'} \\ -C_{\sigma\sigma'}^* & C_{\sigma\sigma}^* \end{pmatrix}$
TSDW ^g	real GHF	$\hat{\mathcal{K}}$	$\begin{pmatrix} C_{\sigma\sigma} & C_{\sigma\sigma'} \\ C_{\sigma'\sigma} & C_{\sigma'\sigma'} \end{pmatrix}, \quad C \in \mathbb{R}$
TSW ^h	complex GHF		$\begin{pmatrix} C_{\sigma\sigma} & C_{\sigma\sigma'} \\ C_{\sigma'\sigma} & C_{\sigma'\sigma'} \end{pmatrix}$

^a Time-reversal invariant closed-shell. ^b Charge current wave. ^c Axial spin current wave. ^d Axial spin density wave. ^e Axial spin wave. ^f Torsional spin current wave. ^g Torsional spin density wave. ^h Torsional spin wave. ⁱ $\hat{\mathcal{K}}$ and $\hat{\Theta}$ are the complex conjugation and time reversal operators.

Stuber-Paldus classification of Hartree-Fock solutions



Recommended references

- Introduction to Computational Chemistry (Jensen)
- Essentials of Computational Chemistry (Cramer)
- Modern Quantum Chemistry (Szabo & Ostlund)
- Molecular Electronic Structure Theory (Helgaker, Jørgensen & Olsen)

